Australian Government
Australian Taxation Office

Individual tax return instructions 2026

To help you complete your tax return for 1 July 2025 – 30 June 2026



For more information go to ato.gov.au

NAT 71050-06.2026

Our commitment to you

We're committed to providing you with reliable, accessible and useful information to help you understand your rights and entitlements and your obligations.

If you follow our information in this publication and it's misleading or turns out to be incorrect and you make a mistake as a result, we must still apply the law correctly. If that means you owe us money, you must pay it, but we won't charge you a penalty. Also, if you act reasonably and in good faith we won't charge you interest.

If correcting the mistake means we owe you money, we will pay it and pay you any interest you're entitled to.

For more information, go to ato.gov.au/howyouareprotected

If you feel that this publication doesn't fully cover your circumstances, or you're unsure how it applies to you, you can seek further help from us.

Our Charter outlines the commitments we make to you and everyone we work with, what we ask of you and steps you can take if you're not satisfied. For more information, go to ato.gov.au/ourcharter

We regularly revise our publications to take account of any changes to the law, so make sure that you have the latest information. If you're unsure, you can check for more recent information at ato.gov.au or contact us.

This publication is current at **June 2026**.

Foreword

Individual tax return instructions 2026 is a guide that shows you how to prepare your tax return correctly. For most people, it covers all you need to prepare your tax return, but the more technical and less common information is available at ato.gov.au/instructions2026

If you have internet access, try lodging online with myTax, it's the quick and easy way to lodge. myTax is a web product, so you don't need to download anything and you can lodge your tax return on any device – computer, smartphone or tablet. If you lodge online, we generally issue your refund within 10 business days, and if you think you made a mistake or forgot to include something in your tax return you can amend it online using your myGov account. To find out more about lodging online, go to ato.gov.au/lodgeonline

You can find our most popular calculators and tools on our website at ato.gov.au/calculators. Our website also has occupation and industry guides and information about work-related expenses, rental properties and much more to help you complete your tax return.

At the back of this guide you'll find more details about our website publications to help you complete your tax return, and how to contact us.

If you do your best to complete your tax return correctly, whether through myTax or on paper, you'll not be subject to penalties if you get things wrong. All you need to do is take reasonable steps to ensure that the information you provide is as complete and accurate as possible.



Keep on top of your tax and super with the ATO app

The ATO app makes it easy to access and manage your tax and super on the go:

- Follow your tax return from start to finish – check available pre-fill information before you lodge and easily track the progress and outcome of your return
- Keep your tax records in one place using myDeductions
- View all your super funds, including any you have lost track of, or forgotten about
- Access useful tools and calculators.

Find out more at ato.gov.au/app

A myGov account linked to the ATO is required for a personalised tax and super experience.

Download on the App Store

GET IT ON Google Play

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Completing your tax return is easier online with myTax



Easy – We'll fill out your tax return with information as it's reported by employers, banks, government agencies, health funds and other third parties.

Fast – You'll get your refund faster, generally within 10 business days.

Secure – Your information is protected.

Remember, you can also lodge with a registered tax agent.

Find out more at ato.gov.au/lodgeonline

DE-56553

Do you need the supplementary tax return instructions 2026?

Individual supplementary tax return instructions 2026 contains questions that aren't in the *Individual tax return instructions 2026*. Check the list below to see whether you need the *Individual tax return (supplementary section) 2026* (Supplementary tax return) to complete your tax return.

Income

13 Income from partnerships and trusts*

14 Personal services income*

15 Net income or loss from business*

16 Deferred non-commercial business losses*

17 Net farm management deposits or repayments

18 Capital gains (from all sources including shares, real estate and other property)

19 Foreign entities

20 Foreign source income and foreign assets or property, including foreign source pension or annuity

21 Rent

22 Bonuses from life insurance companies and friendly societies

23 Forestry managed investment scheme income

24 Other income (income not listed elsewhere)

* If you're a partner in a partnership that makes a loss, or you need to complete income questions **14**, **15** or **16**, you should lodge your tax return using myTax or a registered tax agent.

If you're unable to use myTax or a registered tax agent, contact us on **13 28 66** and we'll send you a paper tax return that includes the *Business and professional items schedule 2026*.

Deductions

D11 Deductible amount of UPP of a foreign pension or annuity

D12 Personal superannuation contributions

D13 Deduction for project pool

D14 Forestry managed investment scheme deduction

D15 Other deductions not claimable elsewhere in your tax return

Tax offsets

T3 Superannuation contributions on behalf of your spouse

T4 Zone or overseas forces

T5 Invalid and invalid carer

T6 Landcare and water facility

T7 Early stage venture capital limited partnership

T8 Early stage investor

T9 Other refundable tax offsets

Adjustment

A5 Amount on which family trust distribution tax has been paid

How to get *Individual supplementary tax return instructions 2026*

Individual supplementary tax return instructions 2026 are only available online at ato.gov.au/suptaxreturninstructions2026

You can get a copy of the form *Tax return for individuals (supplementary section) 2026* from our Publications Ordering Service at iorder.com.au

What's new this year?

New initiatives or legislation that may affect the individual tax return or supplementary tax return 2026.

Rental property income and expenses

We have issued a Taxation Ruling and 2 Practical Compliance Guidelines covering when amounts received are assessable income and what expenses you can and can't claim for rental properties, including rental property that is a holiday home.

Taxation Ruling TR 2026/1 Income tax: rental property income and deductions for individuals who are not in business provides guidance for individuals that earn income from their rental property. It covers earning income from:

- the short-term rental market (such as using online booking or sharing platforms), including renting out a holiday home or letting a room (or rooms) in a home
- letting out a property, or part of a property to long-term tenants.

The Ruling explains:

- when amounts you receive for the use of your rental property will be assessable income
- when losses or outgoings you incur relating to your rental property can be claimed as deductions
- how to apportion your deductions when there are both income producing and non-income producing uses of your rental property
- when certain deductions for your holiday home, that you also use as a rental property, will be denied because it is a 'leisure facility' that is not used or held for use mainly to earn assessable rental income.

Practical Compliance Guideline PCG 2026/2 Apportionment of rental property deductions – ATO compliance approach

This guideline explains appropriate methods for apportioning rental expenses when a property is used to produce assessable income and for another purpose (for example, partly rented and partly your residence).

In these situations, losses and outgoings related to the property will need to be apportioned on a 'fair and reasonable' basis to work out the deduction that can be claimed.

Practical Compliance Guideline PCG 2026/3 Application of section 26-50 to holiday homes that you also rent out – ATO compliance approach

This guideline outlines how to manage your compliance risks under section 26 50 of the *Income Tax Assessment Act 1997*, a tax law integrity provision. Section 26-50 denies deductions for losses or outgoings that relate to the ownership or use of a holiday home unless an exception applies.

The Ruling and the PCGs apply to years commencing both before and after the date of issue, subject to the transitional approach relating to section 26-50 set out in Appendix 2 of the Ruling and referred to in paragraphs 11 and 12 of PCG 2026/3.

Denying deductions for ATO interest charges

If you incurred general interest charge (GIC) or shortfall interest charge (SIC) on or after 1 July 2025, you can't claim it as a deduction in your 2025–26 or later tax returns. GIC or SIC incurred before 1 July 2025 remain deductible in the 2024–25 and earlier income years.

Modernising trust administration systems

From 1 July 2026, your trustee will provide additional information in your distribution statement that can help you prepare your return and report your income correctly.

We're enabling pre-fill services for trust distributions for individual taxpayers from 2026 and expanding to other entities from 2027.

Distribution statement

There will be 3 new labels in your distribution statement:

- B1 Non-primary production managed investment scheme amount
- U2 Franked distribution related to investments amount
- H1 Other assessable foreign source income from a financial investment amount.

This will help you to accurately complete the income tests question at Net financial investment loss (IT5).

Junior Mineral Exploration Incentive

The Junior Mineral Exploration Incentive has not been extended beyond 30 June 2025. From 1 July 2025 exploration credits cannot be received or claimed.

Zone or overseas forces tax offset

From Tax Time 2026, the zone or overseas forces tax offset calculator will be updated to make it easier to use and help prevent errors.

What's changing:

- Location search
  - You can search eligible locations directly in the calculator. As you type, it will automatically find the location and show the correct zone.
- Entering dates and days
  - You can enter dates or the number of days spent in each location. Using dates speeds up the calculation and you won't need to work out days in a zone.
- Simpler adjusted taxable income (ATI) inputs
  - If you have dependants, the calculator now makes it easier to enter your dependant's ATI, whether above or below the relevant thresholds.

Do you need to lodge a tax return?

Review the following reasons to work out if you need to lodge a tax return. If any of the reasons apply to you, then you must lodge a tax return.

Reason 1

During 2025–26, you're an Australian resident and you either:

- paid tax under the pay as you go (PAYG) withholding or instalment system
- had tax withheld from payments made to you (excluding mining payments).

Reason 2

During 2025–26, you're eligible for the seniors and pensioners tax offset, **and** your rebate income (not including your spouse's) is more than:

- **$34,919** if you're single, widowed or separated at any time
- **$33,732** if you had a spouse, but one of you live in a nursing home or you had to live apart due to illness (go to, ato.gov.au/liveapartduetoillness)
- **$30,994** if you live with your spouse for the full income year.

To work out your rebate income, see 'Rebate income' in **Definitions** or go to ato.gov.au/incometestscalculator

Reason 3

You're not eligible for the seniors and pensioners tax offset, **but**:

- you received a payment from the list at question **5 Australian Government allowances and payments**, and
- your taxable income (from taxable income or loss in your tax return) is more than **$22,575**.

Reason 4

You're not eligible for the seniors and pensioners tax offset, **and** the following applies:

- you don't receive a payment from the list at either:
  - question **5 Australian Government allowances and payments**
  - question **6 Australian Government pensions and allowances**
- your taxable income is more than
  - **$18,200** if you're an Australian resident for tax purposes for the full income year
  - **$416** if you're under 18 years old on 30 June 2026 and your income isn't salary or wages
  - **$1** if you're a foreign resident and you had income taxable in Australia which doesn't have a final non-resident withholding tax withheld from it
  - your part-year tax-free threshold amount, if you became or stopped being an Australian resident for tax purposes; see question **A2 Part-year tax-free threshold**.

Reason 5

During 2025–26, you're a foreign resident and the following applies:

- the total of your repayment income and any foreign-sourced income is more than **$16,750**
- on 1 June 2025 you had a debt accumulated for
  - Higher Education loan programme (HELP)
  - VET Student Loan (VSL)
  - Australian Apprenticeship Support Loan (AASL) debt.

If this applies to you, you must lodge your tax return **electronically**. This is even if one of the other reasons applies to you.

Other reasons

You must lodge a tax return if any of the following apply:

- You had a reportable fringe benefits amount on your:
  - income statement
  - *PAYG payment summary – individual non-business*
  - *PAYG payment summary – foreign employment*.
- You had reportable employer super contributions on your:
  - income statement
  - *PAYG payment summary – individual non-business*
  - *PAYG payment summary – foreign employment*
  - *PAYG payment summary – business and personal services income*.
- You're entitled to the private health insurance rebate but you don't claim your correct entitlement as a premium reduction, and your spouse (if you had one) isn't claiming the rebate for you in their tax return.
- You carried on a business during 2025–26.
- You made a loss (including a capital or a non-capital loss on redemption of a traditional security) or you can claim such a loss in a previous year.
- You're 60 years old or older and you received an Australian super lump sum that includes an untaxed element, or you received a super lump sum death benefit as a non-dependant.
- You're under 60 years old and you received an Australian super lump sum that includes a taxed element or an untaxed element or you received a super lump sum death benefit as a non-dependant.
- You're entitled to a distribution from a trust or you had an interest in a partnership, **and** the trust or partnership carries on a business of primary production.
- You're an Australian resident for tax purposes and you had exempt foreign employment income, and **$1** or more of other income. (For more information, see question **20 Foreign source income and foreign assets or property**).
- You're a special professional eligible for the income averaging provisions.

- You received income from dividends or distributions exceeding **$18,200** (or **$416** if you're under 18 years old on 30 June 2026), **and** you had:
  - franking credits
  - amounts withheld because you didn't quote your TFN or ABN to the investment body.
- You derived Australian source taxable income (excluding any super remainder or employment termination remainder) of **$45,001** or more while on a working holiday visa (417 or 462 visa).
- You made personal contributions (not including amounts which you're claiming as a deduction) to a complying super fund or retirement savings account and are eligible to receive a super co-contribution for these contributions.
- Your concessional contributions to your super exceed your concessional contributions cap.
- Your non-concessional contributions to your super exceed your non-concessional contributions cap.
- You're a liable parent or a parent entitled to child support under a child support assessment, **unless**:
  - you received one or more Australian Government allowances, pensions or payments for the whole of the period 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026, and
  - the total of all the following payments is less than **$31,047**
    - taxable income (excluding any assessable first home super saver released amount)
    - exempt Australian Government allowances, pensions and payments
    - target foreign income (see, question **IT4**)
    - reportable fringe benefits total
    - net financial investment loss (see, question **IT5**)
    - net rental property loss (see, question **IT6**)
    - reportable super contributions.

Deceased estate

If you're looking after the estate of someone who died during 2025–26, consider all the above reasons on their behalf. If they don't need to lodge a tax return, complete and lodge the *Non-lodgment advice* on the next page.

If they do need to lodge a tax return, for more information, see **Completing individual information in your tax return**.

Franking credits

If you received franking credits and you don't need to lodge a tax return for 2025–26, you may be eligible to claim a refund of franking credits. Use *Refund of franking credits instructions and application for individuals 2026* (NAT 4105) and lodge your claim online, by mail, or phone **13 28 65**.

Non-lodgment advice

If you have read all the reasons and information and don't need to lodge a tax return, complete a *Non-lodgment advice*, unless one of the following applies to you:

- You have already sent us a tax return, non-lodgment advice, form or letter telling us that you don't need to lodge a tax return for all future years.
- You're lodging an *Application for a refund of franking credits* (NAT 4098).
- Your only income is from an allowance or payment from the list at question **5 Australian Government allowances and payments** or a pension, payment or an allowance from the list at question **6 Australian Government pensions and allowances**, and either
  - your rebate income is less than or equal to the relevant amount in **reason 2** (if you're eligible for the seniors and pensioners tax offset)
  - your taxable income is less than or equal to the relevant amount in **reason 3** (the agencies that pay you provide information for us to determine that you don't need to lodge a tax return).
- You're a working holiday maker on a 417 or 462 visa, and your Australian income is less than **$45,001**.

You can submit a *Non-lodgment advice* using our online services. For more information on online services, go to ato.gov.au/onlineservices

Alternatively, complete the *Non-lodgment advice* on the next page and send it to us.

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Non-lodgment advice

Print neatly in BLOCK LETTERS with a black pen only. Don't use correction fluid or tape.
If you don't need to lodge a tax return, complete this form and send it to us.

Non-lodgment advice for income year ending 30 June ☐☐☐☐

Your tax file number (TFN) ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ See the Privacy statement at Declarations.

Your date of birth Day ☐☐ / Month ☐☐ / Year ☐☐☐☐

Your name

Title – for example, Mr, Mrs, Ms, Miss

Family name

Given names

Your postal address

Suburb or town

State ☐☐☐ Postcode ☐☐☐☐ Country if not Australia

Have you changed your postal address since your last tax return?

No ☐ Read on.

Yes ☐ Print the address on your last notice of assessment or the address you last told us about.

Suburb or town

State ☐☐☐ Postcode ☐☐☐☐ Country if not Australia

Your day time phone number

Area code ☐☐☐☐ Phone number

Reason for not lodging a tax return

☐ I won't have to lodge a tax return this year because none of the reasons listed in the *Do I need to lodge a tax return?* section of the instructions apply.

☐ I won't have to lodge a tax return this year or any future years because:

Declaration

Privacy statement

The ATO is authorised by the *Taxation Administration Act 1953* to request your TFN. We will use your TFN to identify you in our records. It's not an offence not to provide your TFN. However if you don't provide your TFN, there may be a delay in processing this form.

Tax law authorises the ATO to collect information and to disclose it to other government agencies. For information about your privacy go to **ato.gov.au/privacy**

I declare that the information I have given on this non-lodgment advice is true and correct.

The tax law imposes heavy penalties for giving false or misleading information.

Signature

Date Day ☐☐ / Month ☐☐ / Year ☐☐☐☐

OFFICIAL: Sensitive (when completed)

Completing Individual information in your tax return

It's important that you complete the **Individual information** on pages 1 and 2 of your tax return accurately to avoid delaying your notice of assessment (NOA). We provide explanations below for the tax-related questions to help you complete those sections correctly.

If you're not sure whether you need to lodge a tax return, see **Do you need to lodge a tax return?**

Your tax file number (TFN)

You'll find your TFN:

- in ATO online services, you'll need to sign in to your myGov account or login to the ATO app
- on the print-friendly version of your income statement
- on your NOA
- on your super account statement.

You don't have to quote your TFN in your tax return, but if you don't, it may delay your assessment.

If you're new to the tax system and don't have a TFN, go to ato.gov.au/tfn or phone **13 28 61**.

Are you an Australian resident?

For the meaning of Australian resident for tax purposes, see **Definitions**.

If you were an Australian resident for tax purposes for **all** of 2025–26, print **X** in the **Yes** box.

If you were an Australian resident for tax purposes for **part** of 2025–26, print **X** in the **Yes** box and complete question **A2 Part-year tax free threshold** in your tax return. We need this information to work out your tax-free threshold.

If you **weren't** an Australian resident for tax purposes for **all** of 2025–26, print **X** in the **No** box.

If you were in Australia on a 417 or 462 working holiday visa at any time during 2025–26, you must also complete question **A4 Working holiday maker net income** in your tax return. Complete this question to avoid paying tax at a higher rate.

Has any part of your name changed since completing your last tax return?

To find out how to update your name on our records, go to ato.gov.au/updatedetails

Will you need to lodge an Australian tax return in the future?

This may be your last tax return if one of the following applies:

- Your annual taxable income in the future will be below the tax-free threshold ($18,200 for 2026–27).
- Your only source of income in the future will be an Australian Government pension.
- You'll become, or became, eligible for the seniors and pensioners tax offset in 2026–27, and your rebate income is below the threshold for lodging a tax return this year (for threshold levels and eligibility for 2025–26, see **T1 Seniors and pensioners tax offset**).
- You're moving overseas permanently.

Depending on your situation, print **X** in the **Yes**, **Don't know** or **No** box.

Deceased estate

If you're completing a tax return for someone who has died:

- write **DECEASED ESTATE** at the top of page 1 in the tax return
- print **X** in the **No** box at **Will you need to lodge an Australian tax return in the future?**

The executor or administrator of the estate must sign the tax return.

Electronic funds transfer (EFT)

We need your financial institution account details to pay any refund owing to you, even if you have provided them to us before, including:

- Bank State Branch (BSB) number (6 digits, don't include spaces or hyphens)
- account number (no more than 9 digits, don't include spaces or hyphens)
- account name, for example JQ Citizen. Don't show account type, such as cheque, savings, mortgage offset in the account name. Include spaces between each word and initials where required. If this is more than 32 characters, provide the first 32 characters only.

We can only pay your refund into a recognised financial institution account located in Australia.

The tax law provides us with a discretionary power to retain certain tax refunds and credits for up to 90 days while we request valid Australian financial institution account details from you. We can retain the refund from the date the refund or credit becomes payable.

To avoid delays in receiving a refund from us, ensure you provide or update your financial institution details.

Go to, ato.gov.au/fidupdate

If we retain your refund because we don't have valid Australian financial institution details, we will contact you by letter, email, or through a myGov message.

The holding rule doesn't apply where you provide valid Australian financial institution details with your tax return.

1

Salary or wages

Did you earn income from any of the following where tax was withheld:

- salary and wages
- commissions
- bonuses
- money from part-time or casual work
- parental leave pay
- amounts for lost salary or wages paid under
  - an income protection policy
  - a sickness or accident insurance policy
  - a workers compensation scheme
- foreign employment – if you're an Australian Government agency employee (and not a member of a disciplined force), include at this question income you earned delivering Australian Official development assistance.

No Go to question **2**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

You'll need your income statements, *PAYG payment summary – individual non-business, PAYG payment summary – foreign employment,* or similar statement from each employer or payer.

Completing your tax return

1 Write the type of occupation where you earned most of your income at question **1**.

2 If you have more than 5 income statements and payment summaries, go to step 3. Otherwise, read on.

For each income statement and payment summary, write at question **1**:
- the payer's ABN or withholding payer number (WPN)
- the 'Total Australian tax withheld' amounts under **Tax withheld**
- the gross payment amounts under **Income**.

If your income statement or payment summary includes **Gross payment type H,** print **H** in the payment type box. **Gross payment type H** applies to income you earned as a working holiday maker while on a 417 or 462 visa. If this applies to you, you must complete question **A4**.

You have finished this question. Go to question **2**.

3 Complete this step if you have more than 5 income statements and payment summaries. **Gross payment type H**, applies to income you earned as a working holiday maker while on a 417 or 462 visa.

From your income statement and *PAYG payment summary – individual non-business* with no **Gross payment type H**:
- add up the total tax withheld, write the total under **Tax withheld** at the left of label **C**
- add up the gross payment amounts, write the total under **Income** at label **C**
- write the ABN if you have only one income statement or payment summary of this type
- leave the ABN blank if you have more than one income statement or payment summary of this type.

From your income statement and *PAYG payment summary – individual non-business* with **Gross payment type H**:
- add up the total tax withheld, write the total under **Tax withheld** at the left of label **D**
- add up the gross payment amounts, write the total under **Income** at label **D**
- print **H** in the payment **type** box
- write the ABN if you have only one income statement or payment summary of this type
- leave the ABN blank if you have more than one income statement or payment summary of this type.
- complete question **A4**.

From your income statement and *PAYG payment summary – foreign employment*:
- add up the total tax withheld, write the total under **Tax withheld** at the left of label **E**
- add up the gross payment amounts, write the total under **Income** at label **E**
- write the ABN if you have only one income statement or payment summary of this type
- leave the ABN blank if you have more than one income statement or payment summary of this type.

2

Allowances, earnings, tips, director's fees, etc.

This question is about payments from working such as:

- employment allowances
- tips, gratuities, and payments for your service
- consultation fees
- payments for voluntary services (honoraria)
- payments where tax wasn't withheld, including
  - commissions, bonuses
  - money you earned from part-time and casual jobs
  - payments from income protection, sickness and accident insurance policies.

Employment allowances include:

- car and travel allowances
- reimbursements of car expenses your employer calculated by reference to the distance the car travels (that is, it must be on a cents-per-kilometre basis)
- award transport payments (you received under an industrial law or award that was in force on 29 October 1986)
- tool, clothing and laundry allowances
- dirt, height, site, first aid and risk allowances
- meal and entertainment allowances.

If you received an overtime meal-allowance under an industrial agreement or a travel allowance, don't show it in your tax return, if:

- you spent the whole amount on deductible expenses
- your employer didn't report it on your income statement or payment summary
- it doesn't exceed the Commissioner's reasonable allowance amount.

You can't claim deductions for the expenses that you paid for with these allowances.

For more information on reasonable allowances, go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **2**.

Did you receive any of these payments?

No Go to question **3**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

You'll need:

- your income statements, payment summaries or similar statements
- details of any payments you received that aren't shown on an income statement, payment summary or similar statement.

Completing your tax return

1 Add up any tax withheld from these payments. Don't include any amount of tax withheld that you show at question **1**.

Write the total under **Tax withheld** at the left of question **2** – label **K**.

2 Add up all of these income payments.

Write the total under **Income** at question **2** – label **K**.

3

Employer lump sum payments

Did you receive any lump sum payments from your employer for either:

- unused annual leave
- unused long service leave.

No Go to question **4**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

You'll need your income statement, *PAYG payment summary – individual non-business*, *PAYG payment summary – foreign employment,* or a similar statement from your payer that shows an amount at 'Lump sum A' or 'Lump sum B'.

You must go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **3** for instructions on what to do if you either:

- have amounts at 'Lump sum D' or 'Lump sum E'
- pay foreign tax.

Completing your tax return

If you don't have amounts at 'Lump sum A' on your income statements or payment summaries, go to step 4.

1 Add up the tax withheld from lump sum A amounts on your income statements and payment summaries.

Write the total under **Tax withheld** at the left of question **3** – label **R**.

2 Add up all lump sum A amounts on your income statements and payment summaries.

Write the total at question **3** – label **R**.

3 Print in the **TYPE** box at label **R**:

R if the amount relates to one of the following
- a genuine redundancy payment
- an early retirement scheme payment
- the invalidity segment of an employment termination payment or superannuation benefit

T for all other situations.

Check with your payer if you're not sure.

If you don't have amounts at 'Lump sum B' on your income statements or payment summaries, you have finished this question. Go to question **4**.

Otherwise, read on.

4 Add up the tax withheld from lump sum B amounts on your income statements and payment summaries.

Write the total under **Tax withheld** at the left of question **3** – label **H**.

5 Add up all lump sum B amounts on your income statements and payment summaries. Divide the total by 20. This is because only 5% is taxable.

Write the answer at question **3** – label **H**.

4

Employment termination payments

Employment termination payments (ETPs) are payments you received due to the termination of your employment. If you received an ETP, the components of the termination payment may be taxed differently.

These payments appear on your income statement or a *PAYG payment summary – employment termination payment*.

If you lose, leave, or change your job, you may receive several lump sum payments and one may be an ETP.

This question also covers:

- death benefit ETPs
- foreign ETPs
- late termination payments.

For the meaning of these terms and the following terms and what to do if they apply to you go to ato.gov.au/taxtimedefinitions and ato.gov.au/specialcircumstances2026.

Don't show the following payments anywhere in your tax return:

- foreign termination payments
- ETPs you received as the trustee of a deceased estate
- departing Australia superannuation payments.

Did you receive an ETP?

No Go to question **5**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

You'll need your income statement or *PAYG payment summary – employment termination payment*.

You need to convert your foreign ETPs into Australian dollars before you can complete this question. For more information, go to ato.gov.au/specialcircumstances2026 and read **Foreign employment termination payments**.

If you received 2 or more ETPs, go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **4**, under the heading **Completing your tax return – step 5**.

Completing your tax return

1 Write at **Date of payment** the payment date on your income statement or payment summary.

Write at **Payer's ABN**, your payer's ABN from your income statement or payment summary.

2 Write the amount of tax withheld from your ETP, from your income statement or payment summary under **Tax withheld** at the left of question **4** – label **I**.

3 Write the taxable component of your ETP from your income statement or payment summary at question **4** – label **I**.

4 Print the ETP code in the **CODE** box at question **4** – label **I**.

You must enter a valid code, find it on your income statement or payment summary. Contact your employer or payer if income statement or payment summary doesn't have an ETP code. If you're unable to contact your employer or payer, read through the codes below and select one that best describes your payment.

Code	Description
R	If you received your ETP because of: • early retirement scheme • genuine redundancy • invalidity • compensation for – personal injury – unfair dismissal – harassment – discrimination.
O	If your ETP isn't described by code **R**, for example, you received it because of: • golden handshake • gratuity • payment in lieu of notice • payment for unused sick leave • payment for unused rostered days off.
S	If you received a code **R** ETP in 2025–26 **and** you had received another ETP (code **R** or code **O**), or a transitional termination payment, in an earlier income year for the same termination of employment.
P	If you received a code **O** ETP in 2025–26 **and** you had received another ETP (code **R** or code **O**), or a transitional termination payment, in an earlier income year for the same termination of employment.
D	If you received a death benefit ETP and you're a **death benefits dependant**.
B	If you received a death benefit ETP in 2025–26 and you're **not** a death benefits dependant, **and** you had received another death benefit ETP in an earlier income year for the same termination of employment.
N	If you received a death benefit ETP and you're **not** a death benefits dependant, **and** code **B** doesn't apply.

5

Australian Government allowances and payments

Did you receive any of the following Australian Government allowances or payments?

- JobSeeker Payment
- Youth Allowance
- Austudy payment
- Parenting Payment (partnered)
- Special Benefit
- Farm Household Allowance
- an education payment of any of the following when you were 16 years old or older
  - ABSTUDY Living Allowance
  - payment under the Veterans' Children Education Scheme
  - payment shown as a 'MRCA Education Allowance'
- payments under the New Enterprise Incentive Scheme
- other taxable Commonwealth education or training payments (including Commonwealth labour market program payments)
- youth disability supplement as a component of
  - Youth Allowance
  - ABSTUDY Living Allowance
- Disaster Recovery Allowance
- disaster income support allowance for special category visa (subclass 444) holders.

Don't include any Australian Government allowances and payments that aren't taxable. For a list of the most common types of exempt Australian Government allowances and payments, see **Amounts that you don't pay tax on**.

You may need to show the amounts that aren't taxable at question **IT3 Tax-free government pensions or benefits**.

No Go to question **6**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

You'll need either:

- your *PAYG payment summary – individual non-business*
- a letter from the agency that pays your allowance or payment stating the amount you received.

If you can't find or don't have this information, contact the agency that paid you.

Don't include at this question any parental leave payments, you declare these at question **1 Salary or wages**.

Completing your tax return

1 Add up the tax withheld on each of your payment summaries and letters.

Write the total under **Tax withheld** at the left of question **5** – label **A**.

2 Add up the income amounts on each of your payment summaries and letters.

Write the total under **Income** at question **5** – label **A**.

6

Australian Government pensions and allowances

Did you receive any of the following Australian Government payments or allowances?

- Age Pension
- Carer Payment (in some circumstances, the carer payment isn't taxable and shouldn't be included at this question. See **Amounts that you don't pay tax on**)
- Disability Support Pension, if you're age-pension age or over
- Education Entry Payment
- Parenting Payment (single)
- age service pension
- income support supplement
- Veteran Payment
- invalidity service pension, if you're age-pension age or over
- partner service pension (in some circumstances, the partner service pension isn't taxable and shouldn't be included at this question. See **Amounts that you don't pay tax on**).

If you declare government pensions or allowances at this question, you must complete question **T1 Seniors and pensioners tax offset**. This question will help you work out your eligibility for a tax offset.

Don't include any Australian Government pensions or allowances that aren't taxable. For a list of the most common types of exempt Australian Government pensions, allowances and payments, see **Amounts that you don't pay tax on**.

You may need to show the amounts that aren't taxable at question **IT3 Tax-free government pensions or benefits**.

No Go to question **7**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

You'll need either:

- your *PAYG payment summary – individual non-business*
- a letter from the agency that pays your pension, allowance or payment stating the amount you received.

If you can't find or don't have this information, contact the agency that pays you.

Completing your tax return

1 Add up the tax withheld amounts on each of your payment summaries and letters.

Write the total under **Tax withheld** at the left of question **6** – label **B**.

2 Add up the income amounts on each of your payment summaries and letters.

Write the total at **Income** at question **6** – label **B**.

7

Australian annuities and superannuation income streams

Australian **annuities** (or non-super annuities) are a series of regular payments you received from a life insurance company or friendly society in return for a lump sum payment. You can find these payment amounts on your *PAYG payment summary – individual non-business*. If you received this type of annuity, go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **7**.

Australian **super income streams (including lump sum payment in arrears amounts)** are payments you received from Australian super funds, retirement savings account (RSA) providers and life insurance companies. You can find these payment amounts on your *PAYG payment summary – superannuation income stream*.

Super income streams may include:

- account based income streams
- capped defined benefit income streams that are
  - lifetime pensions, regardless of when they start
  - lifetime annuities that exist prior to 1 July 2017
  - life expectancy pensions and annuities that exist prior to 1 July 2017
  - market-linked pensions and annuities that exist prior to 1 July 2017.

If you received a taxable Australian **super lump sum payment**, don't include it here – declare it at question **8**.

Did you receive Australian annuities or super income streams?

No Go to question **8**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

You'll need all your *PAYG payment summary – superannuation income stream*.

You must go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **7** if you received any of the following:

- an Australian annuity
- a capped defined benefit income stream, and one of the following applies:
  - you turned 60 years old during 2025–26
  - you're 60 years old or older on 1 July 2025 and you started the income stream for the first time during 2025–26
  - you're under 60 years old on 30 June 2026 and the income stream is a death benefit income stream where the deceased was 60 years old or older
- a super income stream lump sum payment in arrears
- a super income stream (including a death benefit income stream) with an untaxed element which isn't a capped defined benefit income stream and you're 60 years old or older.

Completing your tax return

To complete this question refer to each *PAYG payment summary – superannuation income stream* you received.

1 Add up the tax withheld amounts on your payment summaries and write the total under **Tax withheld** at question **7**.

2 Add up the untaxed element amounts at *Taxable component*. Write the total at question **7** – label **N**.

3 **On 1 July 2025 were you:**

- 60 years old or older, and
- receiving a capped defined benefit income stream?

Yes Don't complete question **7** – label **J**. Go to step 4.

No Add up the taxed element amounts at *Taxable component*, write the total at question **7** – label **J**. Go to step 4.

4 If you received a capped defined benefit income stream, work out your assessable amount using the worksheet.

Worksheet: Assessable amount from a capped defined benefit income stream

Row	Calculation	Amount
(a)	Add your taxed elements and tax-free components	$
(b)	Subtract $125,000 (your defined benefit income cap) from (a).	$
(c)	If (b) is less than or equal to **0**, write **0** (zero). If (b) is greater than **0**, divide (b) by 2.	$

The amount at row (c) is your **assessable amount from a capped defined benefit income stream**. Write this amount at question **7** – label **M**.

You have finished this question. Go to question **8**.

8

Australian superannuation lump sum payments

This question is about Australian super lump sum payments or super death benefit payments you received, including those from:

- super funds
- approved deposit funds
- RSA providers
- life insurance companies.

It's also about:

- amounts we paid you for the super guarantee charge or the super holding accounts special account
- payments you received from the unclaimed money registers.

Did you receive any of these payments?

No Go to question **9**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

Don't include any of the following:

- Lump sum payments you received as a death benefits dependant of the deceased.
- Taxed element of a super lump sum payment you received on or after your 60th birthday, unless it is a death benefit super lump sum payment you received as a non-dependant.
- Amounts you received because you had a terminal medical condition.
- Departing Australia super payments.

You'll need your *PAYG payment summary – superannuation lump sum*. If you can't find or think there is an issue with your payment summary, contact your payer.

You must go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **8** if any of the following apply:

- you received 2 or more super lump sums during the year, you'll need to provide additional information
- you need to know who is considered a dependant of the deceased
- you have types of super lump sum payments that aren't covered by this question.

Completing your tax return

1. Write the date of payment and your payer's ABN in the left column at question **8**.
2. Write the total amount of tax withheld on your payment summary, under **Tax withheld** at question **8**.
3. From your payment summary, write at question **8**:
   - the taxed element amount at label **Q**
   - the untaxed element amount at label **P**.

   If you received a lump sum death benefit payment, print **N** in the **TYPE** box at question **8**. Otherwise, leave the **TYPE** box blank.

9

Attributed personal services income

Did you receive any attributed personal services income?

You must complete this question if you provide personal services and you either:

- received a *PAYG payment summary – business and personal services income* showing an **X** against 'Personal services attributed income'
- had personal services income attributed to you.

If you received personal services income (PSI) as a sole trader, don't complete this question. You must complete question **14** in the supplementary tax return. If this applies to you, you should lodge your tax return using myTax or a registered tax agent.

If you're unable to use myTax or a registered tax agent, contact us on **13 28 66** and we send you a paper tax return that includes the *Business and professional items schedule 2026*.

For more information on PSI and when it may be attributed to you, go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **9**.

No Go to **Total tax withheld**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

You'll need:

- your *PAYG payment summary – business and personal services income*
- details of any other PSI attributed to you.

If you don't have this information, contact the person who pays you.

Completing your tax return

1. Write the total amount of tax withheld under **Tax withheld** at the left of question **9** – label **O**.
2. Write the total amount of PSI attributed to you at question **P** – label **O**.

Total tax withheld

Total tax withheld is the PAYG withholding amounts withheld during the year by the payer (such as your employer) from the amounts you declare as income at questions **1** to **9**. The main purpose of PAYG withholding is to ensure you can meet your tax liability on this income.

Completing your tax return

1. Add up all the amounts under the **Tax withheld** left-hand column at questions **1** to **9** in your tax return.
2. Write the total at **TOTAL TAX WITHHELD**.

10

Gross interest

Did you receive any interest or credits from any source in Australia?

Gross interest includes:

- interest from savings accounts, term deposits and cash management accounts
- interest we paid or credited to you
- interest from children's accounts you opened or operated with funds that belonged to you or funds used as if they belonged to you
- TFN amounts, that is, amounts withheld by financial institutions because you didn't give them your TFN or ABN.

Read **Do you need the supplementary tax return instructions 2026?** if you received interest from other sources, including interest from a foreign source.

No Go to question **11**.

Yes Read on.

Answering this question

You'll need:

- your statements or other documents from your financial institutions and other sources that show 2025–26 interest income (TFN amounts appear on your statement or document as 'Commonwealth tax' or 'TFN withholding tax')
- any notice of assessment or amended assessment you received from us during 2025–26 that shows interest we paid or credited to you such as interest on early payments, interest on overpayments, and delayed refund interest.

If you have joint accounts, show only your share of the interest.

You must go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **10** for information on how to treat:

- children's accounts you operate
- TFN amounts
- non-resident withholding tax.

Completing your tax return

1. Add up the amounts of gross interest you received in 2025–26.
2. Write the total amount of your gross interest at question **10** – label **L**. Don't show cents. If the total was less than $1, don't write anything.
3. Add up all the TFN amounts from your statements, but don't include TFN amounts that we have already refunded to you.

   Write the total, including cents, at question **10** – label **M**.

11

Dividends

Did you receive any dividends or credits from shares by Australian companies?

Dividends and distributions include:

- dividends applied under a dividend reinvestment plan
- dividends that were dealt with on your behalf
- bonus shares that qualify as dividends
- distributions by a corporate limited partnership
- dividends you received from a corporate unit trust
- dividends you received from a public trading trust
- dividends you received from a listed investment company.

No Go to question **12**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

You'll need your statements from each Australian company that paid you dividends or made distributions to you from 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026 inclusive.

If you had any shares in joint names, show only your amount of the dividends.

Don't include dividends or a distribution where family trust distribution tax has been paid.

You must go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **11** to find out how to complete this question if any of the following apply:

- you received a dividend as a result of a dividend washing arrangement
- you had shares and were under an obligation to make, or were likely to make, a related payment
- within 45 days of buying shares (excluding the dates of purchase and disposal), you either sold them or entered into an arrangement to reduce the risk of making a loss on them (for certain preference shares, this period extends to 90 days)
- you received or were credited with amounts
  - relating to a non-share equity interest
  - by a private company, as a shareholder or associate of a shareholder, in the form of payments, loans or debts forgiven
  - by a trustee of a trust in the form of payments, loans or debts forgiven where a private company in which you were a shareholder, or an associate of a shareholder, had an unpaid present entitlement from the trust
  - when you weren't an Australian resident for tax purposes.

Completing your tax return

If any of your statements don't show franked and unfranked portions of the dividend, show the total dividend amount at label **T**.

1. Add up all the unfranked dividend amounts from your statements, including any TFN amounts withheld. Include any other amounts that are treated as dividends.

   Write the total at question **11** – label **S**.

2. Add up all the franked dividend amounts from your statements and any other franked dividends paid or credited to you.

   Write the total at question **11** – label **T**.

3. Add up the franking credit amounts from your statements. Don't include them if the **holding period rule**, **related payments rule** or **dividend washing integrity rule** prevent you from claiming them. For more information, see *You and your shares 2026*.

   Write the total at question **11** – label **U**.

4. Add up any TFN amounts withheld that haven't been refunded to you.

   Write the total, including cents at question **11** – label **V**.

   Keep your dividend statements.

12

Employee share schemes

This question is about **discounts** on employee share scheme interests (ESS interests) that you or your associate received under an employee share scheme. ESS interests are:

- shares
- stapled securities (provided at least one of the stapled interests is a share in a company)
- rights to acquire shares and stapled securities.

Treat an ESS interest your associate acquired in respect of your employment as though you acquired the ESS interest.

The discount is the difference between the market value of the ESS interests and the amount you paid to acquire them.

The ESS interests can:

- be from an Australian company or a foreign company
- relate to your employment inside or outside Australia
- relate to a work relationship other than employment – for example, sub-contracting.

Schemes where you paid tax on the discount in the year you acquire the interest are known as 'taxed-upfront schemes'. However, if you and the scheme meet certain conditions the taxing point is deferred until a later time, this is known as the 'deferred taxing point'. These tax-deferred schemes are known as 'deferral schemes'.

Changes to ESS interests acquired on or after 1 July 2015 include:

- changes to the timing of the 'deferred taxing point'
- a tax concession through which some discounts on ESS interests in start-up companies will not be taxed under the ESS regime, if you meet the eligibility criteria. Subsequent gains on the disposal of these ESS interests will be taxed under the capital gains tax rules.

Discounts on eligible ESS interests provided to you by a start-up company will not be included on your *Employee share scheme statement* and shouldn't be included at this question.

Ceasing employment with the employer you acquired the ESS interests from isn't a deferred taxing point. If you cease employment the deferred taxing point will become the earliest of the remaining deferred taxing points. This applies to ESS interests under deferral schemes, regardless of when they are acquired.

For more information on ESSs, go to ato.gov.au/keychangesess

Did any of the following apply to you?

- You received a discount on ESS interests acquired under a 'taxed-upfront scheme'.
- A 'deferred taxing point' occurred in respect of your ESS interests under a 'deferral scheme'.

No Go to **Income in your supplementary tax return**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

You'll need your *Employee share scheme statement* from each employer with whom you participated in an ESS.

An *Employee share scheme statement* can include similar statements from your employer and statutory declarations.

If you don't have all your *Employee share scheme statements*, contact your employer.

For more information, go to ato.gov.au/essemployees, if:

- you're a temporary resident or foreign resident when you received your ESS interests
- you dispose of your ESS interests because of a corporate restructure or takeover and received replacement ESS interests
- you received ESS interests from a foreign employer.

If your ESS interests are from a foreign employer, you might not have an *Employee share scheme statement*. A foreign employer can provide you the relevant details in writing.

You can use our ESS calculator to help you answer this question. Go to ato.gov.au/esscalculator

Completing your tax return

If an associate of yours, for example your spouse, acquired an ESS interest as a result of your employment, you must include their discount in your assessable income. Your associate doesn't include the discount in their tax return.

1 Add up the discount amounts you received from 'taxed-upfront schemes eligible for reduction' from your statements.

Write the total at question **12** – label **D**.

2 Add up the discount amounts you received from 'taxed-upfront schemes not eligible for reduction' from your statements.

Write the total at question **12** – label **E**.

3 Add up the discount amounts you received from 'deferral schemes' where a deferred taxing point occurs during 2025–26 from your statements.

Write the total at question **12** – label **F**.

4 If you didn't write an amount at label **D** add up the amounts that you wrote at label **E** and label **F**.

Write the total at question **12** – label **B**. Go to step 6.

If you wrote an amount at label **D**, continue to step 5.

5 If you wrote an amount at label **D**, you may be entitled to reduce the amount of the discounts you received under 'taxed-upfront schemes' by up to $1,000.

To work out whether you're entitled to this reduction, calculate your taxable income without including any discount reduction and excluding any assessable first home super saver released amount. If you had a taxable loss, treat it as zero for the purposes of this calculation.

Add the following amounts from the relevant labels to your taxable income:

- your total reportable fringe benefits amounts (question **IT1 –** labels **N** and **W**)
- your reportable employer super contributions (question **IT2** – label **T**)
- your net financial investment loss (question **IT5** – label **X**)
- your net rental property loss (question **IT6** – label **Y**)
- your deductible personal super contributions (question **D12** – label **H**).

If the amount that you calculate was greater than $180,000, you're not entitled to a reduction. Add up the amounts that you wrote at labels **D**, **E**, and **F**. Write the total at question **12** – label **B**.

If the amount that you calculate was $180,000 or less, you're eligible for the reduction of up to $1,000. If the amount at label **D** is:

- $1,000 or less, add up the amounts that you wrote at labels **E**, and **F** and write the total at question **12** – label **B**.
- More than $1,000, add up the amounts at labels **D**, **E**, and **F** then subtract $1,000 away from the total and write the amount at question **12** – label **B**.

6 Add up all the TFN amounts withheld from discounts from your *Employee share scheme statements*. Write the total **TFN amounts withheld from discounts** at label **C**.

7 If you don't pay foreign income tax in respect of any discounts you received, you have finished this question. Otherwise, read on.

If you paid foreign income tax in respect of the discounts, you may be entitled to claim a foreign income tax offset for discounts.

Write at question **12** – label **A** the total amount of your discounts from ESS interests for which you're claiming a foreign income tax offset.

To claim a foreign income tax offset, you must complete the supplementary tax return question **20** – label **O** in your tax return. For information on how to calculate a foreign income tax offset, read *Guide to foreign income tax offset rules 2026*.

Income in your supplementary tax return

Did you receive income that you need to show in your supplementary tax return?

If you're unsure, read **Do you need the supplementary tax return instructions 2026?**

No Go to **Total income or loss**.

Yes You must complete the relevant income questions in the supplementary tax return, then read on.

Completing your tax return

1 Transfer the amount you wrote at **TOTAL SUPPLEMENT INCOME OR LOSS** in your supplementary tax return to **Income** section – label **I** in your tax return.

If the amount is a loss, print **L** in the **LOSS** box at the right of the amount.

Total income or loss

Completing your tax return

1 Add up all the amounts in the right-hand column for questions **1**–**12** in your tax return.

2 If you have no amount at **TOTAL SUPPLEMENT INCOME OR LOSS** – label **I** in your tax return, go to step 3. Otherwise read on.

If the amount at label **I** is a loss, subtract it from your total at step 1. Otherwise, add the amount at label **I** to your total at step 1.

3 Write the total at **TOTAL INCOME OR LOSS**.

If the amount is a loss, print **L** in the **LOSS** box.

Claiming deductions

You may be able to claim deductions for **work-related expenses** you incurred in the course of your employment duties or while performing your work duties as an employee. You **incurred** an expense in 2025–26 if you either:

- received a bill or invoice for an expense that you're liable for (even if you paid it after 30 June 2026)
- didn't receive a bill or invoice but you paid for the expense.

If your expense includes an amount of goods and services tax (GST), the GST is part of the total expense and is therefore part of any deduction. For example, if you incurred union fees of $440 which included $40 GST, you claim a deduction for $440.

Basic rules

To claim a deduction for work-related expenses:

- you must have spent the money yourself and not received a reimbursement
- the expense must be directly related to earning your income
- you must have a record to prove it (usually a receipt).

The expense must not be private, domestic or capital in nature. For example, the costs of normal travel to and from work, and buying lunch each day are private expenses.

If you incurred an expense that is both work-related and private or domestic in nature, you only claim a deduction for the work-related part.

If you received a partial reimbursement for an expense, you can only claim a deduction for the part that wasn't reimbursed.

Record keeping for work-related expenses

When you claim a deduction, you need to keep records that show you incurred the expense. Records are written evidence of your income or expenses, these can be either paper or electronic. You need to keep records that support the claims you make in your tax return.

You need to keep records for 5 years (in most cases) from the date you lodge your tax return.

If the total amount of deductions you're claiming is more than $300, you must have written evidence (such as a receipt or invoice) to show you incurred and didn't receive a reimbursement for the expenses you claim.

The written evidence and records you keep must prove the total amount you claim, not just the amount over $300.

The $300 threshold doesn't include car expenses, meal allowance expenses, award transport payment expenses and travel allowance expenses. There are special written evidence rules for these claims which we explain at the relevant questions in the instructions.

If the total amount you're claiming is $300 or less, you need records (such as calendar entries or a spreadsheet) to be able to show how you work out your claims, but you don't need written evidence (such as receipts or invoices).

Advance expenditure

If you prepaid for a service costing $1,000 or more, and the service extends for a period of more than 12 months or beyond 30 June 2027 (such as a subscription to a journal relating to your profession), you can claim only the prepaid amount that relates to 2025–26. You can also claim the proportion of your pre-paid expenses from a previous year that relate to 2025–26. For more information, see *Deductions for prepaid expenses 2026*.

Go to ato.gov.au/prepaidexpenses2026 to get a copy of this publication.

Allowances

If you received an allowance that you show at question **2** in your tax return, you can claim a deduction for expenses the allowance covers, but only if you:

- actually incurred the expenses in producing your employment income
- meet the basic rules.

For example, if you received a tools allowance of $500 and your tool expenses were $300:

- include the whole allowance of $500 at question **2** in your tax return
- you claim a deduction of $300 at question **D5** if you have written evidence (such as a receipt for the purchase of the tools).

Decline in value of a depreciating asset

You may be able to claim a deduction for the decline in value of a depreciating asset you held during 2025–26 if you used it to produce income that you show in your tax return.

A depreciating asset is an asset that has an effective life and can reasonably be expected to decline in value over time. Depreciating assets include items such as tools, reference books, computers and office furniture.

Work out the decline in value of a depreciating asset using its effective life. You can either make your own estimate of its effective life or use the Commissioner's effective life determinations. You may be able to claim an immediate deduction for the full cost of depreciating assets costing $300 or less, if certain conditions are met.

For more information, see *Guide to depreciating assets 2026* (NAT 1996).

Go to ato.gov.au/depreciatingassets2026 to get a copy of this publication.

D1

Work-related car expenses

Work-related car expenses are expenses you incurred for a car you own, lease or hire under a hire-purchase agreement. You don't need to be the registered owner, but if you weren't you must be able to show there is a private arrangement that makes you the owner or lessee of the car.

Did you have any work-related car expenses?

No Go to question **D2**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

What can you claim?

To claim a deduction for work-related car expenses as an employee, you must have incurred the expenses in the course of performing your employment duties.

Car expenses include decline in value, registration, insurance, maintenance and cleaning costs, repairs and fuel costs.

Expenses you incurred must also relate to work-related trips, such as travelling between workplaces. For example, when you travel from your workplace to a client's premises to meet with them. You can also claim the cost of using your car to travel directly between 2 separate places of employment when you have a second job, providing one of the places isn't your home.

You can't claim a deduction for expenses you incurred for normal trips between your home and regular place of work.

In very limited circumstances, where eligible, you can claim expenses you incurred for trips between home and work if:

- you used your car to transport bulky tools or equipment (they are bulky because their size and weight which make them awkward to transport other than by car), which were essential to perform your employment duties and can't be left at work because there was no secure storage
- your home was a base for employment (you must have started your employment duties at home and travelled to your normal workplace to continue those particular duties for the same employer)
- you had shifting places of employment (you regularly worked at more than one place before returning home each day).

If the travel was partly private, you can claim only the part that related to travel for a work purpose.

For more information on trips between home and work and between workplaces, go to ato.gov.au/tripsbetweenhomeandwork
For more information on motor vehicle and car expenses, go to ato.gov.au/carexpenses26

Methods

To calculate your deduction there are 2 methods, you must choose either:

- Cents per kilometre method – a rate of 88c per kilometre for 2025–26 up to a maximum of 5,000 work-related kilometres. No written evidence of expenses is necessary with this method, but you need to be able to show how you work out your work-related kilometres (for example, by producing a calendar or diary records of work-related trips).
- Logbook method – you can claim the work-related use percentage (using your logbook and odometer records) of your all your car expenses.

You can use the method that gives you the largest deduction or is most convenient if you have appropriate records to support your claim.

If you're using the logbook method, you must go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **D1**.

To work out your claim, go to ato.gov.au/carexpensescalculator

Completing your tax return

1 If you're using the logbook method you must go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **D1**, then go to step 3.

If you're using the cents per kilometre method, read on.

2 Use the following table to work out the amount you can claim:

(a) Total work-related kilometres (can't be more than 5,000 km)	
(b) Multiply (a) by $0.88 (which is the cents per kilometre rate for all cars). The result is the dollar amount you can claim.	

If you're claiming for more than one car using this method, repeat step 2 for each car and add up all the amounts at (b).

3 Write the total amount at question **D1** – label **A**.

4 Print the relevant code letter from the table below in the **CLAIM TYPE** box beside the amount.

Code letter	Method
S	Cents per kilometre
B	Logbook

D2

Work-related travel expenses

To claim a deduction for work-related travel expenses as an employee, you must have incurred the expenses in the course of performing your work. They include:

- public transport, air travel and taxi fares
- bridge and road tolls, parking fees and short-term car hire
- overnight travel expenses, such as meal, accommodation, and incidental expenses
- expenses for motorcycles and vehicles with a carrying capacity of one tonne or more, or 9 or more passengers, such as utility trucks and minibuses
- actual expenses, such as petrol, repair and maintenance costs, that you incurred to travel in a car that someone else owned or leased.

If the travel was partly private, you can claim only the part that related to work travel. If your employer provided a vehicle for you or your relatives' exclusive use (including under a salary sacrifice arrangement) and you or your relatives used it for non-work purposes:

- you can't claim a deduction for work-related expenses for operating the vehicle, such as petrol, repairs and other maintenance (this is the case even if the expenses relate directly to your work)
- you can claim expenses such as parking, bridge and road tolls for a work-related use of the vehicle, excluding parking at or travelling to a normal or regular place of work.

You must claim at this question any work-related travel expenses you incurred in earning income shown on an income statement or a *PAYG payment summary – foreign employment*.

Meal, accommodation, and incidental expenses

If you want to claim meal, accommodation and incidental expenses, you must have incurred the expenses when you travelled and stayed away from your home overnight in the course of performing your work duties. You must have also paid for the expenses yourself and not get reimbursed.

You can't claim meal, accommodation and incidental expenses, if the expenses you incurred are because:

- you lived a long way from where you work because of your personal circumstances
- there was a change to your regular place of work and you live away from your usual residence to be closer to your new regular place of work (living away from home)
- you chose to sleep at or near your workplace rather than returning to your home between shifts.

If you want to claim meal, accommodation and incidental expenses you incurred when you travelled away overnight for work, see **Travel expense records** in **Definitions** to work out what evidence you need.

Travel allowances for overnight travel

Your employer may have paid you a travel allowance to cover travel allowance expenses you incurred when your travel involved sleeping away from home overnight to perform your employment duties.

Receiving a travel allowance from your employer doesn't automatically mean you can claim a deduction. You can only claim a deduction for the deductible travel allowance expenses that you actually incurred.

You don't have to include the allowance at question **2**, where all the following apply:

- your income statement or payment summary didn't show the travel allowance
- the travel allowance was equal to or less than the reasonable allowance amount for your circumstances
- you fully spent it on deductible work-related travel expenses.

If you don't include the allowance at question **2**, you can't claim a deduction for these expenses at this question.

> You must go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **D2** if your allowance was above the reasonable allowance amounts.

Did you have any work-related travel expenses?

No Go to question **D3**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

If your total claim for all work-related expenses is $300 or less, you need records (such as a document or spreadsheet) to show how you calculate your claim. If you exceed the $300 limit, you must have written evidence of all your expenses (such as receipts or invoices), unless an exception applies.

If you received a travel allowance from your employer, you may be eligible for the record keeping exception.

You need to keep records for 5 years (in most cases) from the date you lodge your tax return. For more information on records and record-keeping exceptions, go to ato.gov.au/RKexceptions2026

Completing your tax return

1. Add up all your deductible travel expenses.
2. Write the total at question **D2** – label **B**.

D3

Work-related clothing, laundry and dry-cleaning expenses

Work-related clothing expenses are the costs you incurred for clothing that is:

- **protective clothing and footwear**, such as fire-resistant clothing, sun protection clothing, safety-coloured vests, non-slip nurse's shoes, steel-capped boots, gloves, overalls, aprons, and heavy-duty shirts and trousers (but not jeans) that you wear while working to either
  - protect you from the real and likely risk of illness or injury
  - prevent damage to your ordinary clothes, your work or work environment may cause (you can claim the cost of protective equipment, such as hard hats and safety glasses at question **D5**)
- a **non-compulsory uniform** that your employer has registered on the Register of Approved Occupational Clothing (check with your employer if you're not sure)
- a **compulsory uniform** that is a set of clothing or a single item that is distinctive (such as one that has your employer's logo permanently attached to it) and identifies you as an employee of an organisation. Your employer must make it compulsory to wear the uniform through a strictly enforced workplace agreement or policy. Items may include shoes, stockings, socks and jumpers where they are an essential part of a distinctive compulsory uniform and your employers policy specifies the colour, style and type
- **occupation-specific clothing** that allows people to distinctly identify your occupation (such as the chequered pants a chef wears when working) and aren't for everyday use.

You can also claim the cost of renting work-related clothing from these categories.

Laundry, dry-cleaning and repairs

You can also claim the costs you incurred to launder, dry-clean or repair work clothing from these categories.

You can't claim the cost of buying or cleaning plain uniforms or clothes, such as black trousers, white shirts, suits or stockings, even if your employer requires you to wear them.

If you launder, dry and iron your work-related clothing, a reasonable basis for working out your claim is:

- $1 per load for work-related clothing
- 50c per load if you mix personal items of clothing with work clothing from one of the categories above.

Use the actual costs you incurred to work out your claim for dry-cleaning and repair expenses.

You must claim at this question any deductible work-related clothing, laundry and dry-cleaning expenses you incurred in earning income that shows on an income statement or a *PAYG payment summary – foreign employment*.

If you received assessable foreign employment income that isn't on an income statement or a *PAYG payment summary – foreign employment*, you must claim your deductions at question **20**.

For more information, go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **D3**.

Did you have any work-related clothing, laundry or dry-cleaning expenses?

No Go to question **D4**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

If your total claim for all work-related expenses is $300 or less, you need records (such as a document or spreadsheet) to show how you calculate your claim.

If you exceed the $300 limit, you must have written evidence of all your expenses (such as receipts or invoices), except the laundry expenses (excluding dry-cleaning) if they are $150 or less.

Total laundry expenses $150 or less

If your total claim for work-related laundry expenses is $150 or less, you can claim a deduction without written evidence. You will however, need a record (like a spreadsheet or document) that shows:

- a description of your work-related clothing
- how you worked out the amount of your claim.

If your total work-related expenses exceed the $300 limit, you can still claim laundry expenses of $150 or less as part of the $300 without written evidence. For more information on these limits and evidence you require, go to ato.gov.au/RKexceptions2026

You need to keep records for 5 years (in most cases) from the date you lodge your tax return.

Completing your tax return

1. Add up all your deductible work-related clothing, laundry and dry-cleaning expenses.
2. Write the total at question **D3** – label **C**.
3. Select the code from the table below that describes the main type of work-related clothing you're claiming for. Print the letter in the **CLAIM TYPE** box at question **D3** – label **C**.

Work-related clothing codes

Code	Type of work-related clothing
C	Compulsory work uniform
N	Non-compulsory work uniform
S	Occupation-specific clothing
P	Protective clothing

D4

Work-related self-education expenses

To claim a deduction for work-related self-education expenses, you must have incurred the costs to:

- undertake a course at an educational institution (whether they lead to a formal qualification or not)
- undertake a course by a professional or industry organisation
- attend a work-related conference or seminar
- complete self-paced learning and study tours (whether within Australia or overseas).

You must be able to show, at the time you incurred the expense, it had a sufficient connection to your employment activities.

A self-education expense has a sufficient connection to earning your employment income if it either:

- maintains or improves the specific skills or knowledge you require for your current employment activities
- leads to, or is likely to lead to, an increase in your income from your current employment activities.

You can't claim a deduction for a self-education expense that:

- you incurred if you aren't employed
- relates only in a general way to your current employment or profession
- will enable you to get new employment.

To make working out your deductions easier, make sure you keep records throughout the year. Our myDeductions tool in the ATO app is a record-keeping tool you can use to keep track of your records electronically.

What you can claim at this question

If at the time you incurred any of the following expenses, there is a sufficient connection between your course and your employment activities, you can claim them as a deduction:

- tuition fees payable under
  - FEE-HELP – this provides assistance to eligible full fee-paying students, who don't receive support from the Commonwealth to pay tuition fees
  - VET Student Loans – this provides assistance to eligible full-fee paying students doing vocational education and training (VET) accredited courses with an approved VET provider
- self-education expenses you paid with your OS-HELP loan – this is a loan to cover expenses for eligible students receiving Commonwealth support who wish to study overseas towards their Australian higher education award
- meal and accommodation expenses during temporary overnight absences from home to participate in self-education
- expenses such as textbooks, stationery, student union fees, student services and amenities fees and certain course fees
- decline in value of your computer (apportioned depending on private use and use for self-education)
- travel expenses to undertake the deductible self-education course for each of the following trips
  - your home to your place of education back to your home
  - your workplace to place of education back to your workplace
- travel expenses related to the first leg of the following trips
  - your home to your place of education back to your workplace
  - your workplace to your place of education back to your home.

If you received assessable foreign income from your work as an employee outside of Australia that shows on an income statement or a *PAYG payment summary – foreign employment*, you must claim any work-related self-education expenses you incurred in earning that income at this question.

What you can't claim at this question

You can't claim contributions or repayments you, or the Australian Government, make under:

- the Higher Education Loan Program (HELP), including FEE-HELP and HECS-HELP
- the Student Financial Supplement Scheme (SFSS)
- the Student Start-up Loan (SSL)
- the Australian Apprenticeship Support Loan (AASL)
- the Vocational Education and Training Student Loan (VSL).

You can't claim any deductions against government assistance payments, including Austudy, ABSTUDY and Youth Allowance.

If you received any assessable foreign income that isn't on an income statement or a *PAYG payment summary – foreign employment*, you must claim your deductions against that income at question **20**.

Did you have any work-related self-education expenses?

No Go to question **D5**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

If your total claim for all work-related expenses is $300 or less, you need records (such as a document or spreadsheet) to show how you calculate your claim. If you exceed the $300 limit, you must have written evidence of all your expenses (such as receipts or invoices).

If you received assessable foreign income from your work as an employee outside of Australia that shows on an income statement or a *PAYG payment summary – foreign employment*, you must claim any work-related self-education expenses you incurred earning that income at this question.

You need to keep records for 5 years (in most cases) from the date you lodge your tax return.

Completing your tax return

To work out your claim, use the self-education expenses calculator at ato.gov.au/educalc or use the worksheet below.

1 If you use the calculator, transfer the amount you work out to question **D4** – label **D** in your tax return and then go to step 3.

If you're not using the calculator, read on.

2 Add up your work-related self-education expenses under the following categories:

Worksheet

Category	Your amount
A General expenses that are deductible, including textbooks, stationery, student union fees, student services and amenities fees, course fees and public transport fares. Include in this category, car expenses (other than the decline in value of a car) you work out under the 'logbook' method. For more information on how to calculate your deduction for these expenses, go to ato.gov.au/carexpenses26	$
B Deductions for the decline in value of depreciating assets you use for self-education, including computers and cars for which you're claiming deductions under the 'logbook' method.	$
C Expenses for repairs to items of equipment used for self-education.	$
D Car expenses that relate to your self-education that you're claiming deductions for under the 'cents per kilometre' method. If you use the 'cents per kilometre' method, you can't claim a deduction for decline in value or repairs at category **B** or **C**.	$
Add up the work-related self-education expenses **A**, **B**, **C** and **D**.	$

Transfer the total amount of work-related self-education expenses to question **D4** – label **D**.

3 Select the code, **K** or **I**, that best describes your reason for incurring self-education expenses.

K The self-education maintains or improves a skill or specific knowledge you require for your employment activities.

I The self-education was leading to, or was likely to lead to, an increase in income from your employment activities.

4 Print your code (**K** or **I**) letter from step 3 in the **CLAIM TYPE** box at question **D4** – label **D**.

D5

Other work-related expenses

To claim a deduction for other work-related expenses, you must

- incurred the expense as an employee
- not claimed the expenses elsewhere in your tax return.

These expenses include:

- union fees and subscriptions to trade, business or professional associations
- overtime meal expenses if you received an overtime meal allowance from your employer that was paid under an industrial law, award or agreement, and you
  - purchased and consumed the meal during your overtime
  - included the amount of the overtime meal allowance as income at question **2**
  - kept written evidence, such as receipts, if your claim is more than $38.65 per meal
- reference books, technical journals and trade magazines
- the work-related portion of tools and equipment, such as a computer or office furniture, and professional libraries, you may be able to claim
  - an immediate deduction for the cost of depreciating assets costing $300 or less
  - a deduction for the decline in value of an item that cost more than $300 over its effective life (however, if you no longer use an item and you previously claimed a deduction for its decline in value, you may need to make a balancing adjustment) – for more information, go to ato.gov.au/depreciatingassets2026
- the work-related portion of items that protect you from the risk of injury or illness posed by your work or your work environment, such as hard hats, safety glasses, sunscreens, and other protective items (but not protective clothing and footwear, that you claim at question **D3**)
- the work-related portion of the following costs
  - interest on money you borrowed to buy tools and equipment
  - repair costs for tools or items of equipment
  - phone or internet usage expenses (if you aren't already claiming working from home expenses using the fixed rate method)
- additional running expenses you incurred because you work from home, go to ato.gov.au/wfh2026
- COVID-19 tests you take for work purposes, go to ato.gov.au/covidtests

You can't claim a deduction for:

- the cost of entertainment, fines and penalties
- private expenses, such as childcare expenses and fees paid to social clubs
- the cost of coffee, tea, milk and other general household items you use when working from home even if your employer provides such items when you work at your employer's office or premises
- costs that relate to your children and their education including buying equipment such as iPads and desks
- the decline in value of items primarily used in your employment (such as laptops, portable printers, personal digital assistants, calculators, mobile phones, computer software, protective clothing, briefcases, and tools of trade) if all of the following apply:
  - your employer provided the items
  - some or all of the items were paid for or reimbursed by your employer Bullet point - the benefit is exempt from fringe benefits tax.

To use our home office expenses calculator, go to ato.gov.au/homeofficeexpensescalculator

For more information on what you can and can't claim at this question, go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **D5**.

Did you have any other work-related expenses?

No Go to question **D6**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

If your total claim for all work-related expenses is $300 or less, you need records (such as a document or spreadsheet) to show how you calculate your claim. If you exceed the $300 limit, you must have written evidence of all your expenses (such as receipts or invoices), unless an exception applies.

If you received an overtime meal allowance, you may need your income statement or *PAYG payment summary – individual non-business*.

If you received assessable income from your work as an employee outside Australia that is shown on an income statement or a *PAYG payment summary – foreign employment*, you must claim any work-related expenses you incurred in earning that income at this question. If you haven't already claimed the expense at another question.

If you received assessable foreign employment income that isn't on an income statement or a *PAYG payment summary – foreign employment*, you must claim your deductions against that income at question **20**.

You need to keep records for 5 years (in most cases) from the date you lodge your tax return. For more information on records and record-keeping exceptions, go to ato.gov.au/RKexceptions2026

Completing your tax return

1. Add up all the expenses that you can claim at this question.
2. Write the total at question **D5** – label **E**.

D6

Low-value pool deduction

To claim a deduction for the decline in value of **low-cost** and **low-value** assets, you must:

- use the assets in the course of producing assessable income
- allocate them to a **low-value** pool.

Low-cost assets are depreciating assets that cost less than $1,000.

Low-value assets are depreciating assets that:

- aren't low-cost assets
- on 1 July 2025, have an opening adjustable value of less than $1,000 under the diminishing value method.

Assets you can allocate to a low-value pool include assets you use either:

- in your work as an employee (see questions **D1** to **D5**)
- to gain rental income (see question **21** in the supplementary tax return instructions).

If you claim the deduction at this question, don't claim it at questions **D1** to **D5** or question **21**.

If your low-value pool contains only assets you use in business, you should lodge your tax return using myTax or a registered tax agent.

If you're unable to use myTax or a registered tax agent, contact us on **13 28 66** and we will send you a paper tax return that includes the *Business and professional items schedule 2026*.

Did you allocate assets to a low-value pool in 2025–26 or in a previous year?

No Go to question **D7**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

You must go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **D6** to complete this question.

Completing your tax return

1 Go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and complete question **D6** – **worksheet 1**.

Transfer the amount you work out at **worksheet 1** – row (i) to question **D6** – label **K**.

2 You'll need the closing pool balance for 2025–26 to calculate your low-value pool deduction for 2026–27. Go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and complete question **D6** – **worksheet 2**. Keep a record of your 2025–26 closing pool balance for your tax return in 2026–27.

D7

Interest income deductions

Did you incur expenses in earning the interest income you declare at question 10?

Expenses you may have incurred in earning interest income include:

- bank or other financial institution account-keeping fees for accounts held for investment purposes
- fees for investment advice relating to changes in the mix of your investments
- interest you paid on money you borrow to purchase investments.

No Go to question **D8**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

You'll need your bank or financial institution statements or passbooks.

If you have a joint account or if you share an interest-earning investment, show only your share of the joint expenses.

You must go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **D7** if any of the following apply:

- you borrow money for both private and investment purposes
- you use equipment, such as a computer, for both private purposes and to manage your investments.

Completing your tax return

1 Add up all your deductions for this question.

2 Write the total at question **D7** – label **I**.

D8

Dividend deductions

Did you incur expenses in earning dividends or distributions income you declare at question 11?

Expenses include:

- management fees for investment advice relating to changes in the mix of your investments
- interest you paid on money you borrow to buy shares or similar investments
- costs relating to managing your investments, such as travel and buying specialist investment journals or subscriptions.

You must also complete this question if your dividends include an amount for capital gain from a listed investment company (LIC). The LIC capital gain amount shows separately on your dividend statement. You can also claim 50% of the LIC capital gain, go to ato.gov.au/lic50

No Go to question **D9**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

If you have joint share investments or similar shared investments, show only your share of joint expenses.

If you borrow money to buy assets for your private use and income-producing investments, you can claim only the portion of the interest expenses relating to the income-producing investments.

You'll need the dividend statements that you use at question **11** that show the dividends you received from a LIC.

You may need written evidence of your dividend and distribution expenses. Most of the records you need will be given to you by the company, the fund manager or your stockbroker.

You must go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 to read question **D8**, and ato.gov.au/yourshares2026 to get a copy of *You and your shares 2026* (NAT 2632) if any of the following apply:

- you incurred interest on investments under a capital protected borrowing – this interest may not be fully deductible
- you incurred interest on borrowings relating to certain overseas investments – the thin capitalisation rules may affect your deductions
- you incurred financial advice fees or charges on an investment proposal before acquisition of an asset.

Completing your tax return

1. Add up all your deductions for this question.
2. Write the total at question **D8** – label **H**.

D9

Gifts or donations

Did you make a gift or donation of $2 or more to an organisation that has a deductible gift recipient (DGR) status?

Your receipt will usually indicate whether you can claim a deduction for the gift or donation.

To find out whether an organisation is an approved DGR organisation, contact them or go to abn.business.gov.au

Generally, you can't claim a deduction for a gift or donation if you received something in return – for example, raffle tickets or a dinner.

No Go to question **D10**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

If you make one or more small cash donations, each of $2 or more, to bucket collections – for example, to collections conducted by a DGR for natural disaster victims – you can claim a total deduction of up to $10 for those donations for the income year without a receipt.

To claim donations of more than $10, you need a receipt.

You can go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **D9** for more information on gifts and donations.

You must go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **D9** if you have any of the following:

- gifts of property and shares
- contributions to fund-raising events
- political donations.

Completing your tax return

1. Add up the amounts of all gifts and donations you can claim.
2. Write the total at question **D9** – label **J**.

D10

Cost of managing tax affairs

Did you incur expenses in managing your tax affairs?

No Go to **Deductions in your supplementary tax return**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

To claim a deduction at this question you must have incurred expenses for managing your tax affairs, including:

- the preparation and lodgment of your tax return and activity statements, including costs associated with
  - buying tax reference material
  - obtaining tax advice from a recognised tax adviser (fees you paid to a recognised tax adviser are deductible in the year you incurred them)
  - lodging your tax return through a registered tax agent
  - dealing with us about your tax affairs
  - purchasing software to allow the completion and lodgment of your tax return – you must apportion the cost if you also use the software for other purposes
- travel to obtain tax advice from a recognised tax adviser
- obtaining a valuation needed for a deductible donation of property or for a deduction for entering into a conservation covenant, go to ato.gov.au/specialcircumstances2026 and read **Gifts of property**.
- litigation costs, including
  - court fees
  - Administrative Review Tribunal fees
  - solicitor, barrister and other legal costs
- amounts we charge you for underestimating a varied goods and services tax (GST) instalment or pay as you go (PAYG) instalment
- expenses for complying with your legal obligations relating to another person's or other entity's tax affairs, including
  - complying with the PAYG withholding obligations – for example, where you withhold tax from a payment to a supplier because the supplier doesn't quote an ABN
  - providing information that we request about another taxpayer.

You can't claim:

- penalties for failing to meet your obligations
- tax advice you received from a person who isn't a recognised tax adviser
- receiving financial advice that isn't in relation to managing your tax affairs
- any judgment debt interest that you have to pay as a result of a court case involving your tax affairs.

You must go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **D10** if any of the following apply:

- you want to claim a deduction for an interest charge we impose on you
- you want to find out if your tax adviser is a recognised tax adviser.

Completing your tax return

1. Separate the costs of managing your tax affairs into the following 2 components:
   - litigation costs
   - other expenses incurred in managing your tax affairs.
2. Add up the costs for each component.
3. Write the total cost for each component at question **D10** as follows:
   - litigation costs at label **L**
   - other expenses incurred in managing your tax affairs at label **M**.

Deductions in your supplementary tax return

Do you have any deductions that you need to show in your supplementary tax return?

If you're unsure, read **Do you need the supplementary tax return instructions 2026?**

No Go to **Total deductions**.

Yes You must complete the relevant deduction questions in the supplementary tax return, then read on.

Completing your tax return

1 Transfer the amount you wrote at **TOTAL SUPPLEMENT DEDUCTIONS** in your supplementary tax return to the **Deductions** section in your tax return – label **D**.

Total deductions

Completing your tax return

1 Add up the deductions you claimed at questions **D1** to **D10** and label **D** in the **Deductions** section of your tax return.

If you didn't claim any deductions in your supplementary tax return, you won't have an amount at label **D**.

2 Write the result at **TOTAL DEDUCTIONS** in your tax return.

Subtotal

Completing your tax return

If you show income at **TOTAL INCOME OR LOSS** in your tax return:

- subtract the amount at **TOTAL DEDUCTIONS** from the amount at **TOTAL INCOME OR LOSS**
- write the result at **SUBTOTAL**
- if the amount at **SUBTOTAL** is less than zero, print **L** in the **LOSS** box.

If you show a loss at **TOTAL INCOME OR LOSS** in your tax return:

- add the amount at **TOTAL DEDUCTIONS** to the amount at **TOTAL INCOME OR LOSS**
- write the result at **SUBTOTAL**
- print **L** in the **LOSS** box.

L1

Tax losses of earlier income years

Do you have tax losses from earlier income years?

No Go to **Taxable income or loss**.
Yes Read on.

Complete this question if you have a tax loss from an earlier income year that you didn't claim as a deduction.

You may have a tax loss at question **L1** in 2025–26 that you may be able to claim as a deduction. You must complete this question whether or not you're able to claim a deduction for the loss in 2025–26.

Don't show at this question:

- capital losses
- expenses and losses you incurred in earning foreign income
- deferred non-commercial business losses from a prior income year.

Answering this question

You'll need records of your tax losses from earlier income years.

To complete this question, go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **L1** – **Completing your tax return**.

Completing your tax return

1. Go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **L1** to work out your tax losses of earlier income years, and use the worksheets.
2. Write the relevant amounts at question **L1**.

Taxable income or loss

Did you show amounts at question L1 – labels F or Z?

No Go to step 1.
Yes Go to step 2.

Completing your tax return

1 Transfer the amount you show at **SUBTOTAL** in your tax return to **TAXABLE INCOME OR LOSS**.

If the amount is less than zero, print **L** in the **LOSS** box. Keep a record of this amount to work out your tax losses of earlier income years for next year.

You have completed this question.

2 Add up the amounts at question **L1** – labels **F** or **Z**. Subtract the total from the amount you show at **SUBTOTAL**.

3 Write the result at **TAXABLE INCOME OR LOSS** in your tax return.

You can't have a loss at **TAXABLE INCOME OR LOSS** if you had amounts at labels **F** or **Z**. This is because you can only use your losses from earlier years to reduce your current year taxable income to nil. You can't use them to create a tax loss. Any losses you have remaining can be carried over to future years until you fully recoup them.

T1

Seniors and pensioners (includes self-funded retirees)

You can claim the seniors and pensioners tax offset (SAPTO) if you met all the conditions relating to:

- eligibility for Australian Government pensions or allowances
- rebate income.

If you had a spouse:

- you also need to work out whether they were eligible
- you may not get the SAPTO even if you met all the eligibility conditions as we base the amount of the tax offset on your individual rebate income, not your combined rebate income.

For the meaning of rebate income, combined rebate income and spouse, see **Definitions**.

You can't claim this tax offset if you were in jail for the whole of 2025–26.

If you're eligible for this tax offset, we use the information you provide at this question to work out the amount of your tax offset for you.

You can also use the beneficiary tax offset and seniors and pensioners tax offset calculator to:

- work out whether you're eligible for this tax offset
- get an estimate of your tax offset.

Go to ato.gov.au/btosapto

Answering this question

Condition 1: Eligibility for Australian Government pensions and similar payments

Did any of the following apply to you in 2025–26?

A You show at question **6** in your tax return either:
- an Australian Government pension or allowance from Centrelink
- a pension, allowance or benefit from the Department of Veterans' Affairs (DVA).

B You met the Centrelink age pension age requirement and are eligible for an Australian Government age pension during 2025–26, but didn't receive it because you haven't made a claim or because you didn't meet the income test or the assets test **and** you satisfied one of the following:
- you had been an Australian resident for age-pension purposes for 10 years or more, of which at least 5 years of these were continuous
- you had a qualifying residence exemption because you arrived in Australia as a refugee or under a special humanitarian program
- you received a partner allowance, a widow allowance, or a widow B pension, immediately before turning age pension age
- you're a woman who was widowed in Australia, and
  - you and your late partner were Australian residents when your late partner died
  - you're currently in Australia, and
  - you have been an Australian resident for at least the last 2 years
- you're a woman and on 19 March 2020 you were receiving
  - a wife pension and you weren't receiving a carer allowance or
  - a special needs widow B pension
- you're a woman and on 31 December 2021 you were receiving a widow allowance
- you would have qualified for an age pension under an international social security agreement.

To find out whether you meet the Centrelink age pension age requirement, see **Definitions**.

If you're not sure whether you were eligible for a payment, go to servicesaustralia.gov.au or phone Services Australia on **13 23 00**.

C You met the veteran pension age test and are eligible for a pension, allowance or benefit from Veterans' Affairs during 2025–26, but don't receive it because you haven't made a claim, or because of the income test or the assets test, **and** you were either:
- a veteran with eligible war service
- a Commonwealth veteran, allied veteran or allied mariner with qualifying service.

To find out whether you meet the veteran pension age test, see **Definitions**.

If you're not sure whether you're eligible for a payment, go to dva.gov.au or phone Veterans' Affairs.

Yes You meet **condition 1**. Go to **condition** 2.
No You're not eligible for this tax offset. Go to question **T2**.

Condition 2: Rebate income

You must work out your rebate income to answer this question. You can use the rebate income worksheet in **Definitions**, or our Income tests calculator, go to ato.gov.au/incometestscalculator

Did any of the following apply to you in 2025–26?

- You didn't have a spouse, and your rebate income was less than $52,759.
- You had a spouse, and the combined rebate income of you and your spouse was less than $87,620.
- At any time during 2025–26
  - you and your spouse **had to live apart due to illness** or because one of you was in a nursing home
  - the combined rebate income of you and your spouse was less than $100,104.

No You're not eligible for this tax offset. Go to question **T2**.
Yes You meet **condition 2**. Read on.

Completing your tax return

1 Use the table below and select all the code letters that applied to you at any time in 2025–26.

Seniors and pensioners tax offset code letters	
You're single, separated or widowed.	A
You and your spouse: • were both eligible for the seniors and pensioners tax offset • **have to live apart due to illness** or live apart because one of you is in a nursing home.	B
Your spouse isn't eligible for the seniors and pensioners tax offset, and you and your spouse • **have to live apart due to illness,** or • live apart because one of you is in a nursing home.	C
You and your spouse: • lived together, and • are both eligible for the seniors and pensioners tax offset.	D
You and your spouse: • live together • your spouse isn't eligible for the seniors and pensioners tax offset.	E

'**Have to live apart due to illness**' refers to situations where you and your spouse don't live together because one or both of you have an indefinitely continuing illness or infirmity and, as a result, your combined living expenses are increased.

Did more than one code letter from the previous table apply?

No Go to step 2.

Yes Use the first code letter that applied to you from the previous table, unless one of the 2 circumstances below applies to you.

- Both **A** and **B** applied, and your spouse's taxable income is less than **$18,334** use code **B**.
- Both **A** and **D** applied, and your spouse's taxable income is less than **$12,494** use code **D**.

Your spouse's taxable income is the amount you show at **Spouse details – married or de facto** label **O** in your tax return.

2 Print your code letter in the **TAX OFFSET CODE** box at question **T1** – label **N**.

3

Are you or your spouse a veteran, war widow or war widower?

No Go to step 4.

Yes Select the veteran code letter that applies to you.

Veteran code letters	
You were a veteran, war widow or war widower.	V
Your spouse was a veteran, war widow or war widower.	W
Both codes **V** and **W** applied to you.	X

Print the code letter in the **VETERAN CODE** box at question **T1** – label **Y**.

4 You must read **Income tests** and complete all Income tests questions.

5 If you had a spouse during 2025–26, you must complete **Spouse details – married or de facto** in your tax return.

Any unused portion of tax offset

If both you and your spouse are eligible for the seniors and pensioners tax offset and one of you doesn't use it all, the unused portion may be available for transfer to the other person. We'll work this out automatically and transfer any entitlement.

To work out whether there is any unused spouse's seniors and pensioners tax offset available to transfer to you, we don't take your spouse's other credits and tax offsets into account.

T2

Australian superannuation income stream

Did you show income from an Australian super income stream at question 7 in your tax return?

No Go to **Tax offsets in your supplementary tax return**.

Yes You may be eligible for a tax offset. Read on.

Answering this question

You must go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **T2** if any of the following apply.
You received:

- a capped defined benefit income stream, and
  - you turned 60 years old during 2025–26
  - you're 60 years old or older on 1 July 2025 and start that income stream for the first time during 2025–26
  - you're under 60 years old on 30 June 2026 and that income stream is a death benefit income stream where the deceased was 60 years old or older.
- a super income stream lump sum payment in arrears
- a super income stream (including a death benefit income stream) with an untaxed element which isn't a capped defined benefit income stream and you're aged 60 years old or older.

Completing your tax return

1

At any time in 2025–26 were you under 60 years old?

Yes Add up the tax offsets on your payment summaries. Write the total at question **T2** – label **S**. Go to **Tax offsets in your supplementary tax return**.

No Read on.

2

Did you include an amount at question 7 – label M Assessable amount from capped defined benefit income stream?

Yes You're not entitled to a tax offset on your untaxed element. Go to **Tax offsets in your supplementary tax return**.

No Complete **worksheet 1**.

Worksheet 1: untaxed element of your capped defined benefit income stream

(a) Defined benefit income cap	$ 125,000
(b) Your total taxed element and tax free components	$
(c) Subtract (b) from (a)	$
(d) Your total untaxed element	$
(e) Write the lesser of (c) and (d)	$
(f) Multiply (e) by 10%.	$

This is your tax offset, transfer the amount at row (f) to question **T2** – label **S**.

Tax offsets in your supplementary tax return

Are you entitled to a tax offset in your supplementary tax return?

If you're unsure, read **Do you need the supplementary tax return instructions 2026?**

No Go to **Total tax offsets**.

Yes You must complete the relevant tax offset questions in the *Tax return for individuals (supplementary section) 2026*, then read on.

Completing your tax return

1 Transfer the amount you wrote at **TOTAL SUPPLEMENT TAX OFFSETS** in your supplementary tax return to the **Tax offsets** section in your tax return – question **T**.

Total tax offsets

Completing your tax return

1 Add up all the tax offset amounts you claim at questions **T2** and **T** in your tax return. (We work out the amounts at question **T1** automatically.)

If you didn't claim any tax offsets in the supplementary tax return, you won't have an amount at label **T**.

2 Write the total at **TOTAL TAX OFFSETS** – label **U** in your tax return.

M1

Medicare levy reduction or exemption

Australian residents for tax purposes are subject to a Medicare levy of 2% of their taxable income unless they qualify for a reduction or exemption.

If you were not an Australian resident for tax purposes for the whole of 2025–26, you may be exempt from the Medicare levy. To work out whether you're exempt, see **Part B – Medicare levy exemption.**

For the meaning of Australian resident for tax purposes, see **Definitions**.

We base a:

- Medicare levy reduction on your taxable income
- Medicare levy exemption on specific categories.

You need to consider your eligibility for a reduction or an exemption separately.

Part A – Medicare levy reduction

Answering this question

We base your eligibility for a Medicare levy reduction on your and your spouse's taxable income and your number of dependent children.

Your taxable income must be equal to or less than the relevant upper threshold in **table 1** for you to qualify for a reduction. If your taxable income is equal to or less than the relevant lower threshold, you don't pay the Medicare levy.

We'll work out any reduction for you.

Table 1: Medicare levy thresholds*

Category	Lower threshold	Upper threshold
Taxpayers who received an amount of seniors and pensioners tax offset	$44,268	$55,335[1]
All other taxpayers	$28,011	$35,013

1 The entitlement to the seniors and pensioners tax offsets ceases when rebate income reaches $52,759.

* These figures are based on the increased Medicare levy low-income thresholds announced on 12 May 2026 as part of the 2026–27 Federal Budget. At the time of publication this measure was not law. ato.gov.au/medicarelevylowincome

If you had a spouse, you may not get the seniors and pensioners tax offset even if you meet all the eligibility conditions as we base the amount of the tax offset on your individual rebate income, not your combined rebate income. If you don't get the offset, merely being eligible for it won't entitle you to a Medicare Levy reduction. For the meaning of spouse, see **Definitions**.

If you were single and you had no dependent children during 2025–26, go to **Part B – Medicare levy exemption**.

A dependent child is any child:

- who is an Australian resident who you maintained in 2025–26, and
- whose adjusted taxable income (ATI) is less than the relevant ATI amount, see **Definitions**.

Medicare levy reductions on family income

Family taxable income is either:

- the combined taxable incomes of you and your spouse (including a spouse who dies during 2025–26)
- your taxable income if you were a sole parent with a dependent child or dependent children.

Sole care means that you alone have full responsibility, on a day-to-day basis, for the upbringing, welfare and maintenance of a child or student.

Your family taxable income must be equal to or less than the limits in **table 2** for you to qualify for a Medicare levy reduction:

Table 2: Family taxable income limit*

Taxpayers entitled to seniors and pensioners tax offset	$77,028
All other taxpayers	$59,047
Increase the family taxable income limit by $5,423 for each dependent child. If you were a sole parent, you can increase your family taxable income limit for a dependent child only if the family tax benefit is payable to you for that dependent child.	

* These figures are based on the increased Medicare levy low-income thresholds announced on 12 May 2026 as part of the 2026–27 Federal Budget. At the time of publication this measure was not law. ato.gov.au/medicarelevylowincome

Is your family taxable income below the relevant limit?

No You don't qualify for a Medicare levy reduction on your family taxable income. Read **Part B – Medicare levy exemption** to see if you qualify for an exemption.

Yes Go to step 1.

Completing your tax return

1. Write the number of your dependent children at question **M1** – label **Y**. If you had none, write **0** (zero).
2. Read **Part B – Medicare levy exemption** to see if you qualify for an exemption.

Part B – Medicare levy exemption

Answering this question

You may qualify for an exemption from paying the Medicare levy if you were in any of the following 3 exemption categories at any time in 2025–26:

- medical
- foreign resident
- not entitled to Medicare benefits.

Did any of the exemption categories apply to you at any time in 2025–26?

No Leave question **M1** – label **V** and **W** blank. Go to question **M2**.

Yes Read on.

For the meaning of dependant and maintaining a dependant, see **Definitions**.

Category 1: Medical

In 2025–26, does one of the following circumstances apply to you?

- You were a blind pensioner.
- You were entitled to full free medical treatment for all conditions under **defence force** arrangements or Veterans' Affairs Repatriation Health Card (Gold Card).

No You didn't qualify for an exemption under **Category 1**. Go to **Category 2**.

Yes Read on.

During the period the **Category 1** condition applies to you, you also met one of the following conditions in the table.

Additional medical exemption conditions – type of exemption that applies

Condition	Exemption that applies
You have no dependants.	Full
Each of your dependants (including your spouse if you have one) either: • was in one of the exemption categories • needs to pay the Medicare levy.	Full
You had dependent children in an exemption category but who are also dependants of your spouse, and your spouse either: • had to pay the Medicare levy • met at least one of the **Category 1** conditions and you have a **family agreement** (see **Definitions**) stating that your spouse will pay the half levy for your joint dependants.	Full
You had at least one dependant (for example, a spouse) who both: • wasn't in an exemption category • doesn't have to pay the Medicare levy.	Half
You were single or separated and you: • had a dependent child who isn't in a Medicare levy exemption category, and • were entitled to FTB Part A or the rental assistance component of FTB Part A for that child, and • were in a shared-care arrangement (see **Definitions**). Then exemption from the Medicare levy is on the following basis: • for the days that you **had care** of your dependent child • for the days that you **didn't have care** of your dependent child.	 Half Full
You had a spouse who met at least one of the **Category 1** conditions and you had a dependent child who: • wasn't in an exemption category, and • was dependent on both of you. In this case, either you or your spouse can claim a full exemption and the other can claim a half exemption by completing a **family agreement** (see **Definitions**).	Full or Half

Do you qualify for a Category 1 exemption for all or any of 2025–26?

No You don't qualify for a Medicare levy exemption under **Category 1**. Go to **Category 2**.

Yes You qualify for a Medicare levy exemption for that period. Go to **Completing your tax return – Medicare levy exemption**.

Category 2: Foreign residents

Were you a foreign resident for tax purposes at any time during 2025–26?

No You don't qualify for a Medicare levy exemption under **Category 2**. Go to **Category 3**.

Yes Read on.

If you're a foreign resident for tax purposes for the whole of 2025–26, you can claim a full exemption for the year (365 days).

If you're a foreign resident for tax purposes for only part of 2025–26, you can claim a full exemption for that period, if either:

- you didn't have any dependants for that period
- all your dependants are in an exemption category for that period.

Go to **Completing your tax return – Medicare levy exemption**.

Category 3: Not entitled to Medicare benefits

In 2025–26:

- did you have a Medicare entitlement statement because you were a temporary resident for Medicare purposes and either:
  - you didn't have any dependants for that period
  - all your dependants are in an exemption category for that period?

You also qualify for a full exemption under this category if:

- you were a member of a diplomatic mission or consular post in Australia (or a member of such person's family and you're living with them), and
- you were not an Australian citizen
- you didn't ordinarily live in Australia, and either
  - you didn't have any dependants for that period
  - all your dependants are in an exemption category for that period.

No You don't qualify for a Medicare levy exemption under **Category 3**. Leave question **M1** – labels **V** and **W** blank.
You have finished this question. Go to question **M2**.

Yes You qualify for a full exemption. Read on.

Completing your tax return – Medicare levy exemption

1 Work out the number of days for which you can claim a full exemption and the number of days for which you can claim a half exemption.

The maximum number of days you can claim is 365. If you had overlapping qualifying periods, count the days in those overlapping periods only once. If a full exemption period overlaps a half exemption period, count the overlapping days as a full exemption period.

2 Write the number of days you qualified for a full exemption at question **M1** – label **V**.

Write the number of days you qualified for a half exemption at question **M1** – label **W**.

If you were a temporary resident for Medicare purposes and had a Medicare entitlement statement from Services Australia covering a period in 2025–26 (see Category 3), print **C** in the **CLAIM TYPE** box. Otherwise leave the **CLAIM TYPE** box blank.

We'll work out your exemption entitlement.

If you had a spouse at any time in 2025–26, you must complete question **Spouse details – married or de facto**.

M2

Medicare levy surcharge

This question is compulsory.

The Medicare levy surcharge (MLS) is in **addition** to the Medicare levy. Depending on your income for MLS purposes, the MLS rate is 1%, 1.25% or 1.5% of:

- your taxable income
- your total reportable fringe benefits
- any amount on which family trust distribution tax has been paid.

You may have to pay the MLS for any period during the income year when both of the following apply:

- you, your spouse (even if they have their own income), or your dependants didn't have an 'appropriate level of private patient hospital cover' for the whole of 2025–26
- your income for MLS purposes was above the threshold.

If you're not sure whether you have an 'appropriate level of private patient hospital cover' during 2025–26, contact your registered health insurer. You can also ask your health insurer for a statement showing the number of days that you and all your dependants have an appropriate level of health cover. For the meaning of appropriate level of private patient hospital cover, see **Definitions**.

Dependants

For this question, your dependants (regardless of their income) are your:

- spouse, even if they worked during 2025–26 or have their own income
- children under 21 years old
- children 21 to 24 years old who are studying full time at school, college or university.

Your dependants must have been Australian residents for tax purposes in 2025–26 and you must contribute to their maintenance. For the meaning of Australian resident for tax purposes and maintaining a dependant, see **Definitions**.

Did you and all your dependants have an 'appropriate level of private patient hospital cover' for the whole of 2025–26?

Yes Print **X** in the **Yes** box at question **M2** – label **E**.
You have finished this question.
Make sure you complete **Private health insurance policy details**.

No Print **X** in the **No** box at question **M2** – label **E**.
Read on.

Answering this question

Medicare levy surcharge exemptions

You're exempt from MLS for the whole of 2025–26 if you fit into one of the categories in **table 1** which depend on your circumstances and your income for MLS purposes.

To work out your income for MLS purposes, use **worksheet 1** or go to ato.gov.au/incometestscalculator

Table 1: Exemption categories

For the **whole of** 2025–26, you and all of your dependants either:
- had an appropriate level of private patient hospital cover
- were in a Medicare levy exemption category (see question **M1**).

You were **single** for the **whole of 2025–26**, and:
- you didn't have any dependent children for the whole of 2025–26
- your income for MLS purposes was **$101,000 or less**.

You were **single** for the **whole of 2025–26**, and:
- have a dependent child for the whole of 2025–26
- your income for MLS purposes was **$202,000 or less** (plus $1,500 for each dependent child after the first).

You were **single** for **part of 2025–26**, and:
- you didn't have a dependent child for the whole of 2025–26
- your **spouse** didn't die during the year
- your income for MLS purposes was **$101,000 or less**.

You had a **spouse** (with or without dependent children) **for the whole of 2025–26**, and your combined income for MLS purposes was either:
- **$202,000 or less** (plus $1,500 for each dependent child after the first)
- greater than $202,000 (plus $1,500 for each dependent child after the first) but your own income for MLS purposes was $28,011* or less.

If your spouse died during 2025–26 and you didn't have another spouse on or before 30 June 2026, assume that you had a spouse for the whole of 2025–26 when you work out your MLS income.

* This figure is based on the increased Medicare levy low-income thresholds announced on 12 May 2026 as part of the 2026–27 Federal Budget. At the time of publication this measure was not law. ato.gov.au/medicarelevylowincome

You must go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **M2** if you didn't fit into any of the categories in **table 1** and one of the following applies:

- you were single for part of the year
- you were widowed during the year
- you became or ceased being a sole parent
- you or any of your dependants only had cover for part of the year
- you were an overseas visitor with health cover.

Working out income for MLS purposes

Complete **worksheet 1** below to work out your income and your spouse's income (if you had one during the year) for MLS purposes. You can also go to ato.gov.au/incometestscalculator

If you received exempt foreign employment income, add it to taxable income at row (a).

If your spouse received a lump sum payment in arrears, which is either foreign income (they show at question **20**) or other income (they show at question **24**), then you must complete a Schedule of additional information. You must go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **M2** to find out how to complete the schedule.

Worksheet 1

Row	Working out income for MLS purposes	You	Spouse
(a)	Taxable income from **TAXABLE INCOME OR LOSS** (excluding any assessable first home super saver released amount).	$	$
(b)	Total reportable fringe benefits amount (the sum of question **IT1** – labels **N** and **W**).	$	$
(c)	Amount on which family trust distribution tax has been paid (from question **A5** – label **X** supplementary tax return).	$	$
(d)	Net financial investment loss (from question **IT5** – label **X**).	$	$
(e)	Net rental property loss (from question **IT6** – label **Y**).	$	$
(f)	Reportable employer super contributions (from question **IT2** – label **T**).	$	$
(g)	Deductible personal super contributions (from question **D12** – label **H** supplementary tax return).	$	$
(h)	Your spouse's share of the net income of a trust on which the trustee must pay tax and which has not been included at row (a) (from **Spouse details** – label **T**).		$
(j)	Add the amounts from row (a) to row (h) in each column.	$	$
(k)	Add the amount from row (j) in your column to the amount from row (j) in your spouse's column.		$
	Your income for MLS purposes when you're single is the amount at row (j) in your column. Your combined income for MLS purposes is the amount at row (k).		

If your spouse receives a lump sum payment in arrears, which is either foreign income (they show at question **20**) or other income (they show at question **24**), then you must complete a *Schedule of additional information*. You must go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **M2** to find out how to complete the schedule.

Completing your tax return

1 If you had private patient hospital cover for any part of the year, you must also complete question **Private health insurance policy details**.

If you and all your dependants had an appropriate level of private patient hospital cover for the whole of 2025–26, print **X** in the **Yes** box at question **M2** – label **E**. You have finished this question.

If you or any of your dependants didn't have private patient hospital cover or only had cover for part of the year, print **X** in the **No** box at the right of question **M2** – label **E**.

Go to step 2.

2 If you were in an exemption category (see **table 1**) for the whole of 2025–26, print **X** in the **Yes** box to the left of 'You don't have to pay the surcharge' and write **365** at question **M2** – label **A**. You have finished this question. Go to **Private health insurance policy details**.

If you weren't in an exemption category, print **X** in the **No** box to the left of 'You may have to pay the surcharge'. Go to step 3

3 Write at question **M2** – label **A** the number of **days for which you don't have to pay MLS**.

If you **don't** have to pay MLS for any days during the period 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026, write **365** at question **M2** – label **A**.

If you need to pay MLS for:

- the whole period 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026, write **0** (zero) at question **M2** – label **A**
- part of the period 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026, write the number of **days for which you don't have to pay MLS** at question **M2** – label **A**.

4 Write the number of dependent children you had during 2025–26 at question **IT8** – label **D**.

Make sure you complete:

- **Income tests** in your tax return
- **Spouse details – married or de facto**, if you had a spouse during the income year, in your tax return.

Private health insurance policy details

Complete this question if at any time during 2025–26 you either:

- **have private health insurance policy cover**
- **paid for a dependent person-only policy**

If you don't have your own policy, you may have cover as a dependent person on your family policy, if you're under 32 years old or are a person with disability.

For this question, the definition of a dependent person relates to the rules of your health fund. If you're unsure about whether this applies to you, check your family private health insurance policy details or contact your insurer.

No Go to question **A1**.
Yes Read on.

We'll use the information you provide at this question to work out your share of any private health insurance rebate entitlement. This may result in a tax offset or a liability.

For more information on the private health insurance rebate, go to ato.gov.au/privatehealthinsurance

Answering this question

It is optional for registered health insurers to provide you with a private health insurance statement (PHI statement). Your registered health insurer will only provide you a statement if you request one.

You may need a PHI statement when lodging your tax return. Contact your health insurer for a statement to ensure you use the correct details when completing your tax return.

If you had cover as a dependent person on a family policy, use the information on the PHI statement for that policy.

There may be a delay processing your tax return if you don't use your PHI statement and the private health insurance details you provide are incorrect.

If you're an overseas visitor who isn't eligible for Medicare, and therefore not entitled to any private health insurance rebate, don't complete **Private health insurance policy details** in your tax return. For more information, go to ato.gov.au/privatehealthinsurance

Completing your tax return

Use the information on your statement to complete your tax return.

In most cases, there will be 2 rows of information on your PHI statement. One row relates to premiums you paid and rebates you received before 1 April, and the other row relates to premiums you paid and rebates you received on or after 1 April. Transfer to your tax return both rows of information as they appear on your private health insurance statement.

Transfer all rows of information separately to your tax return as they appear on your PHI statement. Don't combine the rows of information.

If you have more than one private health insurance policy, complete the following steps for each row of information on your statement for each policy.

If you have more than 4 rows of information on your statement, you'll need to provide additional information. For more instructions, go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read **Private health insurance policy details**.

1 Transfer the health insurer ID at label **B** on your statement to label **B Health insurer ID** in your tax return.

2 Transfer your private health insurance membership number at label **C** on your PHI statement to label **C Membership number** in your tax return.

3

Did you have cover as a dependent person on a private health insurance policy?

Yes You're not entitled to a private health insurance rebate, however you may be exempt from paying the Medicare levy surcharge.

Print **F** in the **Tax claim code** box in your tax return. If you have more than one row of information to transfer from your PHI statement to your tax return that relate to the same membership number, print **F** in the **Tax claim code** box in each row.

You have finished this question. Go to question **A1**.

No Read on

4 Transfer the whole dollar amount at label **J** on your statement to label **J Your premiums eligible for Australian Government rebate** in your tax return. Don't show percentage figures at label **J**.

5 Transfer the whole dollar amount at label **K** on your statement to label **K Your Australian Government rebate received** in your tax return. Don't show percentage figures at label **K**.

6 Transfer the number at label **L** on your statement to label **L Benefit Code** in your tax return.

Working out your tax claim code

7

On 30 June 2026, if you were:

Single Go to step 8.

Married or de facto? (If your spouse died during 2025–26 and you didn't had another spouse on or before 30 June 2026, you're treated as if you have a spouse on 30 June 2026.) Go to step 9.

8 Select the code that best describes your circumstances.

A	You have no dependants.
B	You have a dependent person (they can be your child or a sibling who is dependent on you for economic support), or you paid for a dependent-person-only policy. If you're a single parent with a dependent child, select tax claim code **B** to ensure that we apply the family thresholds when income testing your private health insurance rebate entitlement.

Print the code in the **Tax claim code** box in your tax return. If you have more than one row of information to transfer from your statement to your tax return that relate to the same membership number, print the same code in the **Tax claim code** box in each row.

You have finished this question. Go to question **A1**.

9 Are you claiming your spouse's share of the rebate?

You can choose to claim your spouse's share of the rebate on their behalf if both of you meet all 3 of the following criteria.

Both of you:

- had cover under the same policy
- had cover for the same period of time
- are together on 30 June 2026.

Alternatively, your spouse can claim for both of you. You and your spouse must agree that only one of you'll claim.

Yes Print **C** in the **Tax claim code** box in your tax return. If you have more than one row of information to transfer from your statement to your tax return that relate to the same membership number, print **C** in the **Tax claim code** box in each row.

Go to step 11.

No Read on.

10

Select the code that best describes your circumstances.

C	You're claiming your share of the rebate, or you're a parent claiming for a dependent-person-only policy.
E	Your spouse is claiming your share of the rebate.

Print the code in the **Tax claim code** box in your tax return. If you have more than one row of information to transfer from your statement to your tax return that relate to the same membership number, print the same code in the **Tax claim code** box in each row.

You have finished this question. Go to question **A1**.

11

You must provide information about your spouse's private health insurance in **Private health insurance policy details** in your tax return.

You'll need your spouse's PHI statement.

Repeat steps 1 to 6 using the information on your spouse's statement. Print **D** in the **Tax claim code** box in your tax return. If you have more than one row of information to transfer from your spouse's statement to your tax return, print **D** in the **Tax claim code** box in each row.

When you finish entering information from your spouse's statement, the number of rows with **Tax claim code D** must equal the number of rows with **Tax claim code C** for the same health insurer ID and membership number.

For example, if there are 2 rows with the same health insurer ID and membership number with **Tax claim code C**, there should also be 2 rows having the same ID and membership number with **Tax claim code D**.

A1

Under 18

If you're under 18 years old on 30 June 2026, you must complete this question or you may pay tax at a higher rate.

Were you under 18 years old on 30 June 2026?

No Go to question **A2**.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

Did any of the following categories apply to you on 30 June 2026?

- You're working full time, or you worked full time for 3 months or more in 2025–26 (ignoring full-time work that was followed by full-time study), and you are intending to
  - work full time for most or all of 2026–27, and
  - not study full time in 2026–27.
- You're entitled to a disability support pension or someone is entitled to a carer allowance to care for you.
- You're permanently blind.
- You're disabled and likely to suffer from that disability permanently or for an extended period.
- You're entitled to a double orphan pension, and you received little or no financial support from your relatives.
- You're unable to work full time because of a permanent disability, and you received little or no financial support from your relatives.
- You're the principal beneficiary of a special disability trust.

No Go to step 2.
Yes Read on.

Completing your tax return

1. If you answer **yes** to any of the categories in the list, write **0** (zero) at question **A1** – label **J**. Print **A** in the **TYPE** box at label **J**.

   You have finished this question. Go to question **A2**. Otherwise, read on.

2. If you answer **no** to any of the categories in the list, add up the following income amounts which you show in your tax return:
   - employment income
   - taxable pensions or payments from Centrelink or the Department of Veterans' Affairs
   - compensation, super or pension fund benefits
   - income from a deceased person's estate
   - income from property transferred to you
     - as a result of another's death of family breakdown, or
     - to satisfy a claim for damages for an injury you suffered
   - income from your own business
   - income from a partnership in which you were an active partner
   - net capital gains from the disposal of any of the property or investments referred to above
   - income from investment of amounts referred to above.

3. Add up all your deductions that relate to the income from step 2 (see the **Deductions** section). Subtract the total of those deductions from the total income you work out at step 2.

4. Write the amount from step 3 at question **A1** – label **J**. You pay tax on this amount at normal rates.

   Write **0** (zero) at question **A1** – label **J**, if one of the following applies:
   - you don't have any of the income listed at step 2
   - the amount from step 3 is $0, or a negative amount.

5. Print **M** in the **TYPE** box at question **A1** – label **J**.

   If the amount from step 4 includes income from primary production, you'll need to provide a schedule of additional information. To find out how to complete the schedule, go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **A1** – step 6.

A2

Part-year tax-free threshold

In 2025–26, did you either:

- **become an Australian resident for tax purposes**
- **stop being an Australian resident for tax purposes?**

If you're not sure whether you're an Australian resident for tax purposes, see **Definitions**.

No Go to question **A3**.
Yes Read on.

Did you receive any Australian Government pension or allowance, which you show at question 5 or question 6?

No Go to **Completing your tax return**.
Yes Read on.

Was this amount only for:

- **Youth Allowance**
- **JobSeeker Payment**
- **a Special Benefit?**

Yes Go to **Completing your tax return**.
No You're entitled to the full tax-free threshold. You don't need to answer this question. Go to question **A3**.

Completing your tax return

1 Write the date you became, or stopped being, an Australian resident for tax purposes in the **Date** box at question **A2**.

2 Write at question **A2** – label **N** the number of months that you're an Australian resident for tax purposes up to 30 June 2026, counting the month during which you became, or stopped being, a resident for tax purposes.

For example:

- if you became a resident for tax purposes in November 2025 and remain a resident for the rest of the income year, you write **8**.
- if you stopped being a resident for tax purposes in September 2025, you write **3**.

A3

Government super contributions

Super co-contribution

Does all of the following apply to you?

- You make eligible personal super contribution to a complying super fund or RSA, not including
  - super amounts you're claiming as a deduction
  - an eligible Downsizer contribution.
- You didn't exceed your non-concessional contributions cap.
- Your total super balance at 30 June 2025 is less than $2,000,000.
- You're under 71 years old on 30 June 2026.
- Your **total income** for 2025–26, was less than $62,488.
- 10% or more of your **total income** was from employment or business income (including from a partnership) or a combination of both.
- You didn't hold a temporary visa at any time during 2025–26 (unless you're a New Zealand citizen or it is a prescribed visa).

Total income for the purposes of super co-contribution is the:

- *sum* of your assessable income, reportable fringe benefits total, and total reportable employer super contributions (RESC)
- *less*, any assessable first home super saver (FHSS) released amount and any allowable business deductions.

Reduce your total RESC (but not below zero) by any excess concessional contributions you include in your assessable income.

Assessable income is your income before taking deductions into account.

You can go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 to find out about eligible personal super contributions, contribution caps and your total super balance.

No You're not eligible for a super co-contribution. Go to **Low income super tax offset**.

Yes Go to **Answering this question**.

Low income super tax offset

Did all of the following apply to you?

- Your adjusted taxable income (ATI) was less than or equal to $37,000.
- Concessional contributions are made to your complying super fund.
- 10% or more of your total income is from employment or business income (including from a partnership) or a combination of both.
- You didn't hold a temporary visa at any time during 2025–26 (unless you're a New Zealand citizen or it is a prescribed visa).

Total income for the purposes of the low income super tax offset is the:

- *sum* of your assessable income, reportable fringe benefits total, and total RESC
- *less*, any assessable FHSS released amount.

Reduce your total RESC (but not below zero) by any excess concessional contributions you include in your assessable income.

Assessable income is your income before taking deductions into account.

You can go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 to find out about concessional contributions and calculating your ATI.

No You're not eligible for a low income super tax offset. Go to question **A4**.

Yes Read on.

Did you show income from a partnership at question 13 in your supplementary tax return?

No You may be eligible for a low income super tax offset. We'll work out the amount for you and pay it directly to your super fund account. Go to question **A4**.

Yes Read on.

Answering this question

Did you show any of the following in your supplementary tax return?

- an amount at questions **14**, **15** or **16**
- a loss at question **13** – labels **N** or **O**.

Yes You should lodge your tax return using myTax or a registered tax agent. If you're unable to use myTax or a registered tax agent, contact us on **13 28 66** and we'll send you a paper tax return that includes the *Business and professional items schedule 2026*.

No Read on.

Did you show income from any of the following in your supplementary tax return?

- deposits or repayments from the farm management deposits scheme (question **17**)
- forestry managed investment scheme income (question **23**) or deductions (question **D14**)
- other income (question **24**).

For information on these types of income, go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026

No Go to **Completing your tax return**.

Yes Before you answer this question, you must complete the *Tax return for individuals (supplementary section) 2026*.

To answer this question, you must use the *Government super contributions workbook 2026* (NAT 73495). Don't use any of the worksheets in Individual tax return instructions to complete question **A3**.

To get a copy of this publication, go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026, then read on.

Completing your tax return

Did any of the following apply to you?

- You show income from a partnership at question **13** (supplementary tax return).
- You're in a joint income group and you have deductions for 2025–26 for any of the following joint income:
  - interest you show at question **10**
  - dividends you show at question **11**
  - distributions from trusts you show at question **13** – labels **L**, **U** or **C** (supplementary section)
  - foreign entities income you show at questions **19** – labels **K** or **B** (supplementary section)
  - foreign source income you show at question **20** – labels **E** or **F** (supplementary section)
  - rental income you show at question **21** – label **P** (supplementary section)
  - bonuses from life insurance companies and friendly societies you show at question **22** – label **W** (supplementary section).

You're in a joint income group if you own income-producing assets with another person or persons. For example, if you had a joint bank account or co-own a rental property.

No Go to step 4.

Yes Read on.

1 Complete **worksheet 1**, you'll need to transfer amounts from your tax return.

Worksheet 1

Interest and dividend income	
(a) Amount from question **10** – label **L Gross interest**	$
(b) Amount from question **11** – label **S Unfranked amount**	$
(c) Amount from question **11** – label **T Franked amount**	$
(d) Amount from question **11** – label **U Franking credit**	$
Trust distributions (supplementary tax return)	
(e) Amount from question **13** – label **L Share of net income from trusts (primary production)**	$
(f) Amount from question **13** – label **U Share of net income from trusts, less capital gains, foreign income and franked distributions (non-primary production)**	$
(g) Amount from question **13** – label **C Franked distributions from trusts (non-primary production)**	$
Foreign entities income (supplementary tax return)	
(h) Amount from question **19** – label **K CFC income**	$
(j) Amount from question **19** – label **B Transferor trust income**	$
Foreign source income (supplementary tax return)	
(k) Amount from question **20** – label **E Assessable foreign source income**	$
(l) Amount from question **20** – label **F Australian franking credits from a New Zealand franking company**	$
Rental income (supplementary tax return)	
(m) Amount from question **21** – label **P Gross rent**	$
Bonuses (supplementary tax return)	
(n) Amount from question **22** **Bonuses from life insurance companies and friendly societies** – label **W**	$
(p) Add all amounts from rows (a) to (n).	$

Transfer the amount at row (p) to **worksheet 3** – row (u). Then work through steps 2 to 8.

2

Were you in a joint income group in 2025–26?

No Go to step 3 and write **0** (zero) at **worksheet 3** – row (v).

Yes Complete **worksheet 2**.

Worksheet 2

For each joint income group you're in, write:

- your share of income in column (q)
- your share of deductions in column (r)
- the **lesser amount** from columns (q) and (r) in column (s).

If you show partnership distributions at question **13**, don't include them in **worksheet 2**.

Worksheet 2

Joint income group	(q) Income	(r) Deductions	(s) Lesser amount
	$	$	$
	$	$	$
	$	$	$
	$	$	$
Add your lesser amounts.			$ (t)

Transfer the amount at row (t) to **worksheet 3** – row (v).

3 Complete **worksheet 3**.

Add all distributions of income from partnerships that you show at question **13** – labels **N** and **O** in your supplementary tax return. Don't include your share of any partnership loss.

Write the total at row (x).

Worksheet 3

Amount from row (p) in **worksheet 1**	$	(u)
Amount from row (t) in **worksheet 2**	$	(v)
Subtract row (v) away from row (u).	$	(w)
Distributions of income work out at step 3	$	(x)
Add rows (w) and (x).	$	(y)

Transfer the amount at row (y) to question **A3** – label **F Income from investment, partnership and other sources**. If row (y) is 0 (zero), print **C** in the **CODE** box at label **F**.

4 **Did you show any 2025–26 employment income or business income in your tax return other than at any of the following?**

- Questions **1**, **2**, **3**, **4** (other than death benefits), **12** – label **B**, **IT1** or **IT2** in your tax return
- **P1** or **P8** in your *Business and professional items schedule 2026*.

This may include foreign employment income you show at question **20** – labels **T** and **U**.

Yes Write the total of these amounts at **worksheet 4** – row (z) then go to step 5.

No Read on.

5 **Ignoring any partnership losses distributed to you, did you receive a share of income from a partnership carrying on a business in which you're a partner?**

Yes Write the total of these amounts at **worksheet 4** – row (aa) then go to step 6.

No Read on.

6

Did you show any amounts in your tax return at questions 1, 2, 3, 4 (other than death benefits), 12 – label B, IT1, IT2, or in the BPI schedule at P1 or P8 for:

- **income other than employment or business income**
- **employment or business income that related to another income year?**

This income may include:

- parental leave pay you received in 2025–26 after your employment ceases
- employment or business income you received in 2025–26 that relates to an earlier income year, such as back payments of salary, wages or unused leave you received as a lump sum.

Yes Write the total of these amounts at **worksheet 4** – row (cc), then go to step 7.

No Read on.

7

Complete **worksheet 4**.

Worksheet 4

Amount you work out at step 4	$	(z)
Amount you work out at step 5	$	(aa)
Add rows (z) and (aa).	$	(bb)
Amount you work out at step 6	$	(cc)
Subtract row (cc) away from row (bb).	$	(dd)

Transfer the amount at row (dd) to question *A3* – label **G Other income from employment and business**. If the amount is negative, print **L** in the LOSS box at label **G**. Read on.

8

Did you have business deductions in 2025–26 other than those you include in the deduction items at P8 in the *Business and professional items schedule 2026*?

Examples include:

- your share of a partnership loss from a business that you include in the amount at question **13** – label **N** or **O**
- deductions at question **13** – label **X** or **Y**, which relate to the business income portion of a partnership distribution
- personal service income deductions at **P1** in your *Business and professional items schedule 2026* which relate to carrying on your business
- deductions you include at question **D10** for costs you incurred in managing your business tax affairs as a sole trader or partnership business.

No Write **0** (zero) at question **A3** – label **H**, then go to question **A4**.

Yes Write the total amount of these amounts at question **A3** – label **H** in your tax return, then go to question **A4**.

A4

Working holiday maker net income

Were you on a 417 or 462 working holiday visa at any time during 2025–26?

No Go to **Income tests**.
Yes Read on.

If at any time during 2025–26 you earned income while in Australia on a subclass 417 or 462 visa, you must complete this question.

Answering this question

Your **working holiday maker net income** is income you earned from an Australian source while you are on a 417 or 462 working holiday visa, less deductions relating to earning that income.

For more information on working holiday makers (WHMs), go to ato.gov.au/whm

Working out your WHM net income

1 Add up your WHM income, that is salary and wages, that you:
- show at question **1** in your tax return
- earned while you're on a 417 or 462 visa.

In most cases, income statements and payment summaries from your employer will show the payment type **H** to indicate that you earned WHM income.

If your income statement or payment summary doesn't show the payment type **H,** but you earned income while you're on a 417 or 462 visa, then include that income in this step.

You must also show the payment type **H** against this income at question **1**.

2 Add up your WHM income, other than salary and wages, that you:
- show in your tax return
- earned during 2025–26 while you're on a 417 or 462 visa.

3 Add together the totals from step 1 and step 2 to get your gross WHM income.

4 Subtract any deductions at questions **D1** to **D10** that relate to earning your WHM income. The result is your WHM **net** income.

If this amount is less than **0** (zero), your WHM **net** income is $0.

The example below explains how to:
- work out your WHM net income
- complete this question.

Example: WHM net income and completing your tax return

Kiara, a citizen of Canada and Chile, is on a working holiday in Australia, on a 417 visa.

Between September 2025 and June 2026 Kiara worked on 4 farms in NSW and earned a total of $47,000. Her deductions relating to this income are $800.

Kiara will show $46,200 at question **A4** – label **D** ($47,000 income from the farms, less $800 deductions relating to earning that income).

Kiara will write Chile at question **A4** – label **E**. This will mean she pays tax at the lower of WHM or Australian resident tax rates. If she writes Canada instead, she would pay tax at the WHM rates. This is because Chile is a non-discrimination article country and Canada isn't.

Kiara also includes her deductions in the deductions section of their tax return.

Completing your tax return

1 Write at label **D** your WHM net income.

2 Write at label **E** your home country. Unless you're also a national of one of these countries – Chile, Finland, Germany, Israel, Japan, Norway, Turkey or the United Kingdom, in which case write that country instead of your home country.

Your home country is where you're from. This will be the country you either:
- are a citizen of
- have a permanent right to reside.

Income tests

You must complete all questions in this section of your tax return. Where the amount is zero, write **0**.

We use income tests to work out whether you:

- can claim certain tax offsets and the amount you're entitled to receive
- can receive some government benefits or concessions
- are entitled to a rebate for your private health insurance
- must pay tax
- must pay Medicare levy surcharge
- had a study and training support loan repayment liability for financial assistance you received from
  - Higher Education Loan Program
  - VET Student Loan
  - Student Financial Supplement Scheme
  - Student Start-up Loan
  - ABSTUDY Student Start-up Loan
  - Australian Apprenticeship Support Loan.

We may also pass this information to other government agencies, such as Services Australia, to ensure you're receiving your correct entitlement to government benefits. We also use income tests to correctly determine any child support payments.

If you need more information on any of the income tests, go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read **Income tests 2026.**

IT1

Total reportable fringe benefits amounts

Reportable fringe benefits are fringe benefit amounts that you received from your employer and had the taxable value of those benefits on your income statement or payment summary.

Did you receive any reportable fringe benefits amounts of $3,773 or more?

No Write **0** (zero) at question **IT1** – labels **N** and **W**. Go to question **IT2**.

Yes Read on.

Completing your tax return

1 Add up all the reportable fringe benefits amounts on your:
- payment summaries with **Yes** at **Is the employer exempt from FBT under section 57A of the FBTAA 1986?**
- income statements at **Reportable fringe benefits – exempt amount**.

Write the total at question **IT1** – label **N**.

2 Add up all the reportable fringe benefits amounts on your:
- payment summaries with **No** at **Is the employer exempt from FBT under section 57A of the FBTAA 1986?**
- income statements at **Reportable fringe benefits – non-exempt amount**.

Write the total at question **IT1** – label **W**.

Go to question **IT2**.

IT2

Reportable employer superannuation contributions

Did your employer make reportable employer super contributions on your behalf?

No Write **0** (zero) at question **IT2** – label **T**.
Go to question **IT3**.

Yes Read on.

These are made in addition to the compulsory contributions your employer must make. An example of a reportable employer super contribution is a contribution made on your behalf under a salary sacrifice arrangement.

If your income statement or payment summary shows a reportable employer super contributions amount and you didn't ask your employer to make additional contributions, contact them to check the amount is correct before lodging your tax return.

Ask your employer to provide you with a revised income statement or payment summary if they have incorrectly calculated the reportable employer super contributions amount.

Completing your tax return

1. Add up the reportable employer super contributions on your:
   - payment summaries
   - income statements.
2. Write the total at question **IT2** – label **T**. Go to question **IT3**.

IT3

Tax-free government pensions or benefits

Did you receive a tax-free government pension or benefit from the list in Definitions?

No Write **0** (zero) at question **IT3** – label **U**.
Go to question **IT4**.

Yes Read on.

We take certain tax-free government pensions or benefits you received in 2025–26 into account when working out your adjusted taxable income (ATI). Your ATI is an income test we use to work out your eligibility for certain tax offsets and the amount of those offsets. You don't pay income tax on tax-free government pensions and benefits.

For a list of tax-free government pensions and benefits, go to ato.gov.au/specialcircumstances2026 and read **Tax-free government pensions or benefits and the income tests**.

Don't include at this question amounts you report at questions **5**, **6** or **7**.

Completing your tax return

1. Add up the amount of tax-free pensions or benefits you received during 2025–26.
2. Write the total at question **IT3** – label **U**. Go to question **IT4**.

IT4

Target foreign income

Target foreign income is:

- income you earned, derived or received from sources outside Australia
- a periodical payment by way of gifts or allowances from a source outside Australia
- a periodical benefit by way of gifts or allowances from a source outside Australia.

An amount isn't target foreign income if you report it in your taxable income or received it in the form of a fringe benefit.

You must include 'exempt foreign employment income' from question **20** – label **N** in your target foreign income total. Don't include any other foreign income amounts that you show elsewhere in your tax return.

For more information on target foreign income, go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **IT4**.

Did you receive any target foreign income?

No Write **0** (zero) at question **IT4** – label **V**.
Go to question **IT5**.

Yes Read on.

Completing your tax return

Show all foreign income in Australian dollars using the market exchange rate for 1 July 2025.

1 Add up all your target foreign income you earned, derived or received during 2025–26.

2 Write the total at question **IT4** – label **V**.
Go to question **IT5**.

IT5

Net financial investment loss

Did you receive income from, or claim deductions for:

- **shares in a company**
- **an investment in a managed investment scheme, including a forestry managed investment scheme**
- **rights or options for shares or managed investment schemes**
- **distributions from a partnership that includes income or losses from an investment type from the list above**
- **any investment that is of a similar nature to those in the list above?**

No Write **0** (zero) at question **IT5** – label **X**.
Go to question **IT6**.

Yes Read on.

The loss you show at this question is the amount by which your deductions from investments exceed your income from those investments.

When you calculate your net financial investment loss, don't include interest from your everyday transaction accounts.

Managed investment schemes

The investment manager will be able to tell you whether your investment is a managed investment scheme. Managed investment schemes include:

- cash management trusts
- property trusts
- Australian equity (share) trusts
- agricultural schemes (including horticultural, aquaculture and commercial horse breeding schemes).

Investments that **aren't managed investment schemes** include:

- regulated super funds
- approved deposit funds
- debentures issued by a body corporate
- franchises
- schemes an Australian bank operates in the ordinary course of banking business (such as term deposits).

Deductions

Deductions you can claim for an investment include expenses you paid to:

- borrow money to purchase an investment
- manage your investments
- get advice about changes in the mix of your investments.

For more information on Net financial investment loss, go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read question **IT5**.

Completing your tax return

Complete **worksheet 1**.

If you were a partner in one or more partnerships, add up your share of all net financial investment income and deduct your share of all net losses from the partnerships' financial investments. The statement of distribution from each partnership should show these amounts. Write the total at row **(q)**.

Worksheet 1

Financial investment income		
Dividends from Australian shares from question **11**:		
• Unfranked amount		(a)
• Franked amount		(b)
• Franking credit		(c)
Managed investment scheme income at question **13** – label **U**		(d)
Share of franked distributions and franking credits from managed investment scheme at question **13** – label **C**		(e)
Dividend income or managed investment scheme income from foreign companies at question **20** – label **M**		(f)
Australian franking credits from a New Zealand franking company from question **20** – label **F**		(g)
Forestry managed investment scheme income from question **23** – label **A**		(h)
Any other assessable income from a financial investment		(i)
Add all amounts from rows (a) to (i).		(j)

Financial investment deductions		
Dividend deductions from Australian shares at question **D8**		(k)
Managed investment scheme deductions at question **13** – label **Y** and question **D8** – label **H**		(l)
Forestry managed investment scheme deductions from question **D14** – label **F**		(m)
Any other deductions attributable to a financial investment, including debt deductions at question **D15** – label **J**		(n)
Add all amounts from rows (k) to (n).		(o)
Subtract row (o) from row (j). Show a loss as a negative.		(p)
Total partnerships investment net income or loss. Show a loss as a negative.		(q)
Add rows (p) and (q).		(r)

If the amount at row (r) is negative, write this amount at question **IT5** – label **X**. Otherwise write **0** (zero) at label **X** and go to question **IT6**.

IT6

Net rental property loss

Net property loss is the amount of net loss from any rental property you owned.

Did you earn rental income, claim rental deductions, or received a partnership distribution that included rental income or losses?

No Write **0** (zero) at question **IT6** – label **Y**. Go to question **IT7**.

Yes Read on.

Completing your tax return

1 Complete **worksheet 1** to work out your net rental property loss.

You must show any loss amounts in **worksheet 1** as negative amounts (including any totals).

At row (c) write your share of net rental property income or loss from the partnership tax return statement of distribution.

At row (d) write the net income or loss from carrying on a rental property business which you use in working out the amount at **P8** – label **Z** of the *Business and professional items schedule 2026*. If this applies to you, then you should lodge your tax return using myTax or a registered tax agent.

If you're unable to use myTax or a registered tax agent, contact us on **13 28 66** and we will send you a paper tax return that includes the *Business and professional items schedule 2026*.

At row (f) write the total of the low-value pool deductions relating to your rental properties from question **D6**.

Worksheet 1

Net rental property loss		
Net foreign rent (from question **20** – label **R**)		(a)
Net rent (from question **21**)		(b)
Share of net rental property income or loss		(c)
Net income or loss from rental property business		(d)
Add rows (a), (b), (c) and (d).		(e)
Total of the low-value pool deductions		(f)
Any other deductions attributable to a rental property, including debt deductions at question **D15** – label **J**		(g)
Add rows (f) and (g).		(h)
Subtract row (h) from row (e).		(i)

2 If the amount at **worksheet 1** – row (i) is negative (that is, a loss), write that amount at question **IT6** – label **Y**. Otherwise, write **0** (zero) at label **Y** and go to question **IT7**.

IT7

Child support you paid

Child support are amounts you paid or benefits you provided to another person other than your partner for the maintenance of your natural or adopted child.

Don't include amounts you paid or provided to a person to acquire goods or services.

Did you pay amounts or provide benefits to another person for the maintenance of your child?

No Write **0** (zero) at question **IT7** – label **Z**.
Go to question **IT8**.

Yes Read on.

Completing your tax return

1. Add up all the amounts you paid and benefits you provided for the maintenance of your child during 2025–26.
2. Write the total at question **IT7** – label **Z**. Go to question **IT8**.

IT8

Number of dependent children

Did you have any dependent children?

No Write **0** (zero) at question **IT8** – label **D**.
Go to **Spouse details – married or de facto**.

Yes Read on.

We use your number of dependent children to work out your entitlement to an increase in the income test threshold for the:

- private health insurance rebate
- Medicare levy surcharge.

Regardless of their income, a dependent child is your child who is either:

- under 21 years old
- 21 to 24 years old and a full-time student at a school, college or university.

The child must be an Australian resident and you must contribute to their maintenance. For the meaning of 'Australian resident for tax purposes' and 'Maintaining a dependant', see **Definitions**.

Completing your tax return

Write the number of your dependent children at question **IT8** – label **D**, then go to **Spouse details – married or de facto**.

Spouse details – married or de facto

Did you have a spouse during 2025–26?

Your spouse includes another person who:

- you were in a relationship with that was registered under a prescribed state or territory law
- although not legally married to you, lived with you on a genuine domestic basis in a relationship as a couple.

No Go to **Taxpayer's declaration** in your tax return.
Yes Read on.

Answering this question

You'll need details of your spouse's income, you can get these from:

- your spouse
- your spouse's *Tax return for individuals 2026* and *Tax return for individuals (supplementary section) 2026* if your spouse completes them
- your spouse's income statement or *PAYG payment summary – individual non-business*
- the relevant distribution statements, if any, for trust income and family trust distribution tax.

If your spouse:

- had child support obligations, you need the details of the amount of child support they paid (your spouse can get this information from Services Australia)
- received foreign income, you need the details of the amount of foreign income they received
- had financial investment losses, you need the net financial investment loss amount
- had rental property losses, you need the net rental property loss amount
- claimed a deduction for personal super contributions, you need the details of the claim.

Including your spouse's income is important as we use it to work out whether:

- you're entitled to
  - a rebate for your private health insurance
  - the seniors and pensioners tax offset
  - a Medicare levy reduction
- you must pay the Medicare levy surcharge.

Request the information you require at this question from your spouse, whether they need to lodge a tax return or not. If you can't find out any of the amounts you require, you can make a reasonable estimate.

We won't penalise you for an incorrect estimate if you act reasonably and in good faith.

If you had more than one spouse during 2025–26, complete this section with the details for your last spouse in 2025–26.

Completing your tax return

1 Print your spouse's name (family, first and other given names) in the boxes at **Your spouse's name**.

Write your spouse's date of birth at label **K**.

Print **X** in the relevant box for your spouse's gender (male, female or indeterminate).

Indeterminate includes non-binary. Your spouse's gender is important for assisting us to correctly identify your spouse.

2 If you had a spouse for the full income year, 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026, print **X** in the **Yes** box at label **L**.

If you didn't have a spouse for the full year, print **X** in the **No** box at label **L** and write the dates you had a spouse in 2025–26 at labels **M** and **N**.

If your spouse died during 2025–26 and you didn't have another spouse on or before 30 June 2026, print **X** in the **Yes** box to the right of **Did your spouse die during the year**? We use this information to calculate your Medicare levy surcharge.

3 Complete all the labels **O** to **E** relating to your spouse's income in your tax return using the information in the tables below. If an amount is zero, write **0**. If you're unable to get the information about your spouse's income, provide a reasonable estimate.

If you need more information, go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read **Spouse details – married or de facto**.

Label	Explanation
O	At label **O** write your spouse's 2025–26 taxable income (excluding any assessable First home super saver released amount). You will usually find your spouse's taxable income on their tax return or notice of assessment. If the amount is a loss, write **0** (zero).
T	At label **T** write the amount of net income of a trust that the trustee was liable to pay tax on because your spouse was under a legal disability, for example, they were a person who was: • bankrupt • declared legally incapable because of a mental condition, or • under 18 years old on 30 June 2026. Don't include an amount that you already report in your spouse's taxable income; for example, at label **O**. Check the trust distribution statements.
U	At label **U** write the amount your spouse has shown at question **A5** – label **X** in their supplementary tax return.

Label	Explanation
R	At label **R** write the amount your spouse has shown at question **IT1** – label **N** in their tax return.
S	At label **S** write the amount your spouse has shown at question **IT1** – label **W** in their tax return.
P	At label **P** write the amount your spouse has shown at question **6** in their tax return.
Q	At label **Q** write the amount of any of the following exempt pension income that your spouse received in 2025–26: • disability support pension paid under Part 2.3 of the *Social Security Act 1991* • youth disability supplement if your spouse received a disability support pension • carer payment paid under Part 2.5 of the *Social Security Act 1991* • invalidity service pension paid under Division 4 of Part III of the *Veterans' Entitlements Act 1986* • partner service pension paid under Division 5 of Part III of the *Veterans' Entitlements Act 1986*. Make sure you include only your spouse's exempt pension income. If this amount is zero, write **0**. Don't include at label **Q** any of the exempt payments in the list at label **B**.
A	At label **A** write the total of the amounts your spouse has shown at: • question **IT2** – label **T** in their tax return • question **D12** – label **H** in their supplementary tax return. If this amount is zero, write **0**.
B	At label **B** write the amount of the following tax-free government pensions your spouse received for 2025–26: • a special rate disability pension paid under Part 6 of Chapter 4 of the *Military Rehabilitation and Compensation Act 2004* • a payment of compensation made under section 68, 71 or 75 of the *Military Rehabilitation and Compensation Act 2004* • a payment of the weekly amount mentioned in paragraph 234(1)(b) of the *Military Rehabilitation and Compensation Act 2004* • a pension for defence, peacekeeping or war-caused death or incapacity or any other pension granted under Part II or Part IV of the *Veterans' Entitlements Act 1986* • income support supplement paid under Part IIIA of the *Veterans' Entitlements Act 1986*. Don't include these amounts at label **Q** above. If this amount is zero, write **0**.

Label	Explanation
C	At label **C** write the amount of any 'target foreign income' of your spouse during 2025–26. Target foreign income is any income, periodic payments or benefits by way of gifts or allowances that: • are from sources outside Australia • aren't included in your spouse's taxable income, and • aren't fringe benefits. You must include any exempt foreign employment income your spouse has shown at – question **20** – label **N** in their supplementary tax return. You must convert all foreign income to Australian dollars before you complete label **C**. If your spouse's target foreign income amount is zero, write **0**.
D	Add the amounts your spouse has shown at questions **IT5** and **IT6** in their tax return and write the total at label **D**. If your spouse's total net investment loss is zero, write **0**.
E	At label **E** write the total amount of child support payments or benefits your spouse provided to another person. Don't count any payments or benefits provided to you by your spouse unless you live apart on a permanent or indefinite basis. If the total amount of child support your spouse provided to another person is zero, write **0**.

4 Complete the **Family Assistance** section in your tax return only if you consent to use part or all of your 2026 tax refund to repay your spouse's Family Assistance debt.

Print **X** in the **No** box.

If you do consent, go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026 and read **Spouse details – married or de facto – step 4**.

5 Complete the **Taxpayer's Declaration** in your tax return.

Checklist

Check you have completed the following before you lodge your tax return:

- ☐ the **Individual information** sections in your tax return
- ☐ your electronic funds transfer details so we can pay any refund owing directly into your financial institution account – we can hold your refund for 90 days if you don't provide valid Australian financial institution account details
- ☐ all **questions** that are relevant to you, including:
  - **M2** – this question is **compulsory** for all taxpayers
  - **Private health insurance policy details**, if required
  - **A1** if you're under 18 years old on 30 June 2026; this is **compulsory** and you may pay tax at a higher rate if you don't complete it
  - **A4** if you're in Australia on a 417 or 462 visa that allows you to work and holiday – this is **compulsory** and you may pay tax at a higher rate if you don't complete it
  - **IT1** to **IT8 Income tests**
  - **Spouse details – married or de facto**, if required, including
    - **Family Assistance consent** – if you consent to offset part or all of your tax refund against your spouse's Family Assistance debt, if required
- ☐ the letter code boxes, if required, at questions
  - **1 Salary or wages**
  - **3 Employer lump sum payments**
  - **4 Employment termination payments**
  - **8 Australian superannuation lump sum payments**
  - **TOTAL SUPPLEMENT INCOME OR LOSS**
  - **TOTAL INCOME OR LOSS**
  - **D1 Work-related car expenses**
  - **D3 Work-related clothing, laundry and dry-cleaning expenses**
  - **D4 Work-related self-education expenses**
  - **SUBTOTAL**
  - **TAXABLE INCOME OR LOSS**
  - **T1 Seniors and pensioners (includes self-funded retirees)**
  - **M1 Medicare levy reduction or exemption**
  - **Private health insurance policy details**
  - **A1 Under 18**
  - **A3 Government super contributions.**
- ☐ written totals at
  - **TOTAL TAX WITHHELD**
  - **TOTAL SUPPLEMENT INCOME OR LOSS** (if applicable)
  - **TOTAL INCOME OR LOSS**
  - **TOTAL SUPPLEMENT DEDUCTIONS** (if applicable)
  - **TOTAL DEDUCTIONS**
  - **SUBTOTAL**
  - **TAXABLE INCOME OR LOSS**
  - **TOTAL SUPPLEMENT TAX OFFSETS** (if applicable)
  - **TOTAL TAX OFFSETS**
- ☐ a *Trust income schedule* to attach to your tax return, if you report amounts for trust distributions at
  - **13 Partnerships and trusts**
  - **18 Capital gains**
  - **19 Foreign entities**
  - **20 Foreign source income and foreign assets or property**
- ☐ the **Taxpayer's declaration**, you need to read, complete, sign and date it
- ☐ attach copies of all documents or schedules the tax return instructions tell you to attach
- ☐ kept copies of your tax return, all attachments, and relevant papers for your own records.

When can you expect your notice of assessment?

We aim to process paper tax returns within 50 business days. If you lodge your tax return online using myTax, our standard processing time is 10 business days.

Definitions

Some of the following definitions apply to all questions, while some only apply to specific questions. Each definition identifies which question it applies to.

Adjusted taxable income (all questions)

Adjusted taxable income (ATI) is an amount that is we most commonly use to work out eligibility for certain tax offsets.

Use the following amounts to calculate a person's ATI:

- taxable income (excluding any assessable First home super saver released amount)
- reportable employer super contributions
- deductible personal super contributions
- adjusted fringe benefits total, which is the sum of
  - reportable fringe benefits amounts from employers exempt from fringe benefits tax under section 57A of the *Fringe Benefits Tax Assessment Act 1986* multiplied by 0.53, and
  - reportable fringe benefits amounts from employers not exempt from fringe benefits tax under section 57A of the *Fringe Benefits Tax Assessment Act 1986*
- certain tax-free government pensions or benefits you received
- target foreign income
- net financial investment loss
- net rental property loss
- less, child support payments you provide to another person.

To work out a person's ATI, go to ato.gov.au/incometestscalculator or use the **ATI worksheet** on the next page. If you're using the calculator and you're working out the dependant's ATI for part of the year or the ATI of a deceased person, you need to read the instructions below.

If you're working out the ATI of a person for the whole year, you can get the amounts for the **ATI worksheet** from the person's tax return.

If you're working out a dependant's ATI for part of the year, you can't use the figures from their tax return. Instead, you must work out the amounts for the period they were a dependant and complete the worksheet using these figures. Follow the instructions at each tax offset question.

If you're completing a tax return for a deceased person, or your spouse died during the year and you need to know their ATI for the whole of 2025–26, their ATI is the amount you work out with the calculator or at row (k):

- divided by the number of days the person was alive in 2025–26, and
- multiplied by 365.

ATI worksheet

		You	Dependant 1	Dependant 2	Dependant 3
The period for which you need to work out the person's ATI	from:	1/7/2025			
	to:	30/6/2026			
The person's taxable income from **TAXABLE INCOME OR LOSS** (excluding any assessable first home super saver released amount). If taxable income is a loss, write **0** (zero).	(a)	$	$	$	$
The person's total reportable fringe benefits amounts from: question **IT1** – label **N**, multiplied by 0.53 and rounded down to the nearest dollar, and question **IT1** – label **W**	(b)	$	$	$	$
The person's reportable employer super contributions from question **IT2** – label **T**	(c)	$	$	$	$
The person's deductible personal super contributions from question **D12** – label **H**	(d)	$	$	$	$
The person's tax-free government pensions or benefits from question **IT3** – label **U**	(e)	$	$	$	$
The person's target foreign income from question **IT4** – label **V**	(f)	$	$	$	$
The person's net financial investment loss from question **IT5** – label **X**	(g)	$	$	$	$
The person's net rental property loss from question **IT6** – label **Y**	(h)	$	$	$	$
Add all the amounts from (a) to (h).	(i)	$	$	$	$
Child support the person provided to a third party from question **IT7** – label **Z**	(j)	$	$	$	$
Subtract (j) from (i). This is the person's ATI for the period.	(k)	$	$	$	$

Appropriate level of private patient hospital cover (question M2)

An **appropriate level of private patient hospital cover** is cover provided by a registered health insurer for hospital treatment in Australia which has an excess of:

- $750 or less (for a policy covering only one person), or
- $1,500 or less (for all other policies).

Excess is the amount you pay before your health insurer pays for any claim you make.

General cover (formerly called ancillary cover) or 'extras' isn't private patient hospital cover because it covers only items such as optical, dental, physiotherapy or chiropractic treatment.

Australian resident for tax purposes (all questions)

Generally, we consider you to be an **Australian resident for tax purposes** if you:

- have always lived in Australia or you have come to Australia and live here permanently
- have been in Australia continuously for 6 months or more, and for most of that time you worked in the one job and lived at the same place
- have been in Australia for more than 6 months during 2025–26, unless your usual home is overseas and you don't intend to live in Australia
- go overseas temporarily and you don't set up a permanent home in another country, or
- are an overseas student who has come to Australia to study and are enrolled in a course that is more than 6 months long.

If you need help in deciding if you're an Australian resident for tax purposes, go to ato.gov.au/residency

Child (all questions)

Child includes:

- your adopted child, stepchild or ex-nuptial child
- your child born or adopted in 2025–26
- a child of your spouse, and
- someone who is your child within the meaning of the *Family Law Act 1975* (for example, a child who is considered to be a child of a person under a state or territory court order giving effect to a surrogacy agreement).

Combined rebate income (question T1)

The **combined rebate income** of you and your spouse is the total of:

- your rebate income
- your spouse's rebate income, and
- the amount on which the trustee of a trust was liable to pay tax in respect of your spouse because your spouse was under a legal disability, such as being an undischarged bankrupt or a person who was declared legally incapable because of a mental condition.

Dependants (question M1 for Medicare levy exemption)

For question **M1**, **dependant** means an Australian resident you maintained who was:

- your spouse
- your child under 21 years old, or
- your child, 21 to 24 years old, who was receiving full-time education at a school, college or university and whose adjusted taxable income (ATI, see pages 67–8) for the period you maintained the child was less than the total of $282 plus $28.92 for each week you maintained them.

See **Maintaining a dependant** in **Definitions**.

If the parents of a child lived apart for all or part of the income year and the child was a dependant of each of them, the child is treated as an equal dependant of each parent. However, where a parent receives Family tax benefit (FTB) Part A for the child, including receiving only the rental assistance component, the child is a dependant of that parent for the number of days the child was in their care.

Dependants (question M2)

For question **M2**, your **dependants** (regardless of their income) are your:

- spouse, even if they worked during 2025–26 or had their own income
- children under 21 years old
- children who are 21 to 24 years old who are studying full-time at a school, college or university.

Your dependants must have been Australian residents in 2025–26 and you must have contributed to their maintenance.

Dependent child (question M1 for Medicare levy reduction)

A **dependent child** is any child who was an Australian resident who you maintain in 2025–26 and whose adjusted taxable income (ATI, in **Definitions**) was less than:

Categories of dependent children	ATI if not maintained for the whole year	ATI if maintained for the whole year
Any child under 21 years old you maintained who was not a full-time student	For the first child: $282 plus $28.92 for each week you maintained them	For the first child: $1,786
	For each additional child: $282 plus $21.70 for each week you maintained them	For each additional child: $1,410
Any full-time student aged under 25 years old at a school, college or university	$282 plus $28.92 for each week you maintained them	$1,786

If a dependent child turned 21 during the year and was not a full-time student after that, they will be a dependent child for the period of the year they were under 21.

Similarly, if a dependent full-time student turned 25 during the year – they will be a dependent child for the first part of the year.

Family agreement (question M1)

A **family agreement** is a written agreement signed by you and your spouse. You complete a **family agreement** only if both you and your spouse would have to pay the Medicare levy were it not for your exemption category status. You don't need to send this agreement to us. Keep it with your records. The agreement must contain:

- the statement: "We agree that the Medicare levy exemption in respect of our dependants for 2025–26 will be claimed as follows."
- name of person claiming the **full** exemption
- name of person claiming the **half** exemption
- your signature
- your spouse's signature.

The agreement must be signed before the date the person claiming the full exemption lodges their tax return unless the Commissioner allows further time.

Income statement

If you're an employee, your income statement will set out your gross salary and wage income, pay as you go (PAYG) amounts withheld, allowances and other payments paid to you by your employer.

If your employer is reporting through Single Touch Payroll, your income statement replaces your payment summary.

You can access your income statement online in myGov. We update your income statement throughout the year when your employer pays you. If your income statement is:

- **tax ready**, your employer has finished with your income statement and you can use it to do your tax return
- **year to date** or **not tax ready**, your employer has not finished with your income statement. Your employer must finalise your information by 14 August.

Incurred (all questions)

You **incurred** an expense in an income year when you:

- received a bill or invoice for an expense that you're liable for and must pay (even if you don't pay it until after the end of the income year), or
- didn't receive a bill or invoice but you're charged and you paid for the expense.

Maintaining a dependant (questions M1, M2 and IT8)

You **maintained a dependant** if any of the following applied:

- you both lived in the same house
- you gave them food, clothing and lodging
- you helped them to pay for their living, medical and educational costs.

If you had a spouse for the whole of 2025–26 and your spouse worked at any time during the year, we still consider you to have maintained your spouse as a dependant for the whole income year.

We consider you to have maintained a dependant even if the 2 of you were temporarily separated, for example, due to holidays or overseas travel.

If you maintained a dependant for only part of the year, it may impact the number of days they are considered a dependant.

Pension age (question T1)

Centrelink	• 67 years old or older
Veterans' Affairs	• veteran or war widow/widower • 60 years old or older, and • meets the veteran pension age test

For more information about the veteran pension age test, see **Definitions**.

Preservation age (questions M1 and M2)

The minimum age a super fund member may be able to access their preserved benefits. The preservation age for those born:

- from 1 July 1963 to 30 June 1964, is 59
- on or after 1 July 1964, is 60.

Rebate income (question T1 and Do you need to lodge a tax return?)

Your **rebate income** determines whether you're eligible for the seniors and pensioners tax offset at question **T1**.

To work out your rebate income, go to ato.gov.au/incometestscalculator or use the following worksheet.

Rebate income worksheet

Your taxable income from **TAXABLE INCOME OR LOSS** in your tax return (excluding any assessable first home super saver released amount) If your taxable income is a loss, write **0** (zero).		(a)
Your adjusted fringe benefits total, which is the sum of: • question **IT1** – label **N** in your tax return multiplied by 0.53 and rounded down to the nearest dollar, and • question **IT1** – label **W** in your tax return		(b)
Your reportable employer super contributions (from question **IT2** – label **T** in your tax return)		(c)
Your deductible personal super contributions (from question **D12** – label **H** in your supplementary tax return)		(d)
Your net financial investment loss (from question **IT5** – label **X** in your tax return)		(e)
Your net rental property loss (from question **IT6** – label **Y** in your tax return)		(f)
Add up all the amounts from (a) to (f). This is your rebate income.		(g)

For more information, go to ato.gov.au/rebateincome

Shared care (question M1 and T4)

You had **shared care** of a child if you, and your spouse if you had one, cared for your child for some of the income year, and someone else, such as a former spouse, cared for the child for the rest of the income year.

If you received family tax benefit (FTB) Part B as part of a shared-care arrangement, you'll need to know your FTB shared-care percentage to calculate your spouse offset. Your FTB shared-care percentage is usually not the same as your 'shared care percentage' which appears on correspondence you have received from Services Australia.

If you don't know your FTB shared-care percentage, contact Services Australia.

Spouse (all questions)

Your **spouse** includes another person who, for 2025–26:

- you were in a relationship with that was registered under a prescribed state or territory law
- although not legally married to you, lived with you on a genuine domestic basis in a relationship as a couple.

Tax-free government pensions or benefits that are taken into account in the income tests (question IT3)

If you received any of the government pensions or benefits listed below, you must include at question **IT3** the part of those pensions and benefits that are exempt from tax. In some cases, all of your pension or benefit could be exempt from tax, and in other cases only part of it might be.

Don't include any part of these pensions and benefits that is a bereavement payment, pharmaceutical allowance, rent assistance or remote area allowance, or language, literacy and numeracy supplement.

Government benefits or payments you may have received include:

- Disability support pension paid by Centrelink to a person who is under age-pension age.
- Youth disability supplement if you received disability support pension.
- Carer payment under Part 2.5 of the *Social Security Act 1991* (note this isn't the 'carer allowance' under Part 2.19 of the *Social Security Act 1991*).
- Pension for defence, peacekeeping or war-caused death or incapacity or any other pension granted under Part II or Part IV of the *Veterans' Entitlement Act 1986*.
- Invalidity service pension where the veteran is under age-pension age.
- Partner service pension where either
  - the partner and the veteran are under the age-pension age and the veteran is receiving an invalidity service pension, or
  - the partner is under age-pension age, the veteran has died and was receiving an invalidity service pension at the time of death.
- Income support supplement paid under Part IIIA of the *Veterans' Entitlements Act 1986*.
- A veteran payment under an instrument made under Park IIIAA of the *Veterans' Entitlements Act 1986*.
- Special rate disability pension under Part 6 of Chapter 4 of the *Military Rehabilitation and Compensation Act 2004*.
- A payment of compensation under section 68, 71 or 75 of the *Military Rehabilitation and Compensation Act 2004*.
- A payment of the weekly amount mentioned in paragraph 234(1)(b) of the *Military Rehabilitation and Compensation Act 2004* (including a reduced weekly amount because of a choice under section 236 of that Act) or of a lump sum mentioned in subsection 236(5) of that Act.

If you're not sure, for the purpose of this question, whether a government pension or benefit you have received is tax-free, phone **13 28 61**.

Travel expense records (question D2)

	Domestic travel		Overseas travel	
	Written evidence	**Travel diary[1]**	**Written evidence**	**Travel diary[1]**
If you didn't receive a travel allowance:				
• travel less than 6 nights in a row	Yes	No	Yes	No
• travel 6 or more nights in a row	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
If you received a travel allowance and your claim doesn't exceed the reasonable allowance amount:				
• travel less than 6 nights in a row	No	No	No[2]	No
• travel 6 or more nights in a row	No	No	No[2]	Yes[3]
If you received a travel allowance and your claim exceeds the reasonable allowance amount:				
• travel less than 6 nights in a row	Yes	No	Yes	No
• travel 6 or more nights in a row	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes[3]

1 A travel diary is a document in which you record the nature, dates, places, times and duration of your activities and travel.
2 Written evidence is required for overseas accommodation expenses regardless of the length of the trip but not for food, drink and incidentals.
3 Members of international aircrews don't have to keep a travel diary if they limit their claim to the amount of the allowance received.

Veteran pension age test (question T1)

You meet the **veteran pension age test** if one of the following applied to you and you were eligible for a pension, allowance or benefit under the *Veterans' Entitlements Act 1986*:

- You have eligible war service, that is, service in World War II or operational service as a member of the Australian Defence Force.
- You were a Commonwealth or allied veteran who served in a conflict in which the Australian Defence Force was engaged during a period of hostilities, that is, World War II, or in Korea, Malaya, Indonesia or Vietnam.
- You were an Australian or allied mariner who served during World War II.
- You were the war widow or widower of a former member of the Australian Defence Force.

'Pension, allowance or benefit' includes:

- disability pension
- service pension, and
- white or gold Repatriation health cards for treatment entitlements.

If you're not sure whether you meet the veteran pension age test, go to the Department of Veterans' Affairs at dva.gov.au or phone them on **13 32 54**.

For more help understanding terms we use in the tax return instructions, go to ato.gov.au/taxtimedefinitions

Amounts that you don't pay tax on

You might have received amounts that you don't need to include as income in your tax return. We classify them into 3 categories:

- **exempt income**
- **non-assessable non-exempt income**
- **other amounts** that aren't taxable and don't affect any calculation in your tax return.

We list the most common types of exempt income, non-assessable non-exempt income and other amounts that generally aren't taxable below. If you're not sure whether a payment you received is exempt income, non-assessable non-exempt income or other non-taxable amount, phone **13 28 61**.

Exempt income

Exempt Australian Government pensions, allowances and payments

- Carer adjustment payment (CAP).
- Carer payment where either
  - **both** the carer **and** the care receiver are under age-pension age
  - the carer is under age-pension age and any of the care receivers have died.
- Disability support pension Centrelink paid to a person who is under age-pension age.
- Double orphan pension.
- Invalidity service pension under the *Veterans' Entitlements Act 1986* where the veteran is under age-pension age.
- Partner service pension where either
  - the partner (excluding the non-illness separated spouse of a veteran) and the veteran are under age-pension age and the veteran receives an invalidity service pension
  - the partner is under age-pension age and the veteran has died and was receiving an invalidity service pension at the time of death.
- Veterans' Affairs disability pension and allowances, war widows and war widowers pension.

Lump sum bereavement payments you received as part of any of the payments in this list are exempt only up to the tax-free amount. To find out how much of your payment is exempt, phone **13 28 61**.

Exempt Australian Government education payments

- Allowances for students under 16 years old, including those allowances you received under ABSTUDY, the Assistance for Isolated Children Scheme and the Veterans' Children Education Scheme.
- Australian–American Educational Foundation (Fulbright Commission) grant.
- Commonwealth scholarships or bursaries for foreign students.
- Commonwealth secondary education assistance.
- Endeavour awards research fellowships or an Endeavour Executive Award.
- Language, literacy and numeracy supplement.
- Payments under the Military Rehabilitation and Compensation Act Education and Training Scheme (MRCAETS) for eligible young persons where you determine eligibility under either
  - paragraph 258(1)(a) of the *Military Rehabilitation and Compensation Act 2004* and the eligible young person was under 16 years old
  - paragraph 258(1)(b) of the *Military Rehabilitation and Compensation Act 2004*.
- Pensioner education supplement and fares allowance from Centrelink.
- Rent assistance Austudy recipients received.
- Some scholarships and bursaries full-time students received.
- Supplementary allowances for students under the Assistance for Isolated Children Scheme.
- The first $1,000 of an apprenticeship early completion bonus you received under a specified state or territory scheme for occupations with skill shortages.

Other exempt Australian Government payments

- Acute support packages for veterans and their families.
- Amounts you received directly, or which a person received on your behalf, under the National Disability Insurance Scheme for approved reasonable and necessary supports your plan funds.
- Australian Government Disaster Recovery Payment.
- Back to school bonus and single income family bonus under the *A New Tax System (Family Assistance) (Administration) Act 1999*.
- Carer allowance paid under the *Social Security Act 1991*.
- Child care subsidy.
- Additional child care subsidy.
- Child disability assistance under Part 2.19AA of the *Social Security Act 1991*.
- Education entry payment supplement under the *Social Security Act 1991*.

- Energy supplement under Part 2.25B of the *Social Security Act 1991* or Part VIIAD of the *Veterans' Entitlements Act 1986*.
- Family tax benefit.
- Household Assistance Package payments which include
  - Clean Energy Advance
  - Energy Supplement payments
  - Essential Medical Equipment payment
  - Single Income Family Supplement.
- Loss of earnings allowance under the *Veterans' Entitlements Act 1986*.
- Lump sum payment under section 198N of the *Veterans' Entitlements Act 1986*.
- Mobility allowance under the *Social Security Act 1991*.
- Outer Regional and Remote (OR&R) payment under the Better Start for Children with Disability initiative.
- Outer Regional and Remote (OR&R) payment under the Helping Children with Autism package.
- Payment from the Thalidomide Australia Fixed Trust.
- Payment for travelling expenses under Part 3 of the *Treatment Benefits (Special Access) Act 2019*.
- Payment of pharmaceutical supplement under Part 4 of the *Treatment Benefits (Special Access) Act 2019*.
- Payments from the Commonwealth to Thalidomide survivors under the Support for Australia's Thalidomide Survivors program.
- Payments from the National Indigenous Australians Agency under the Territories Stolen Generations Redress Scheme.
- Pension bonus and pension bonus bereavement payments under Part 2.2A of the *Social Security Act 1991* or Part IIIAB of the *Veterans' Entitlements Act 1986*.
- Pharmaceutical allowances under the *Social Security Act 1991*.
- Prisoner of War Recognition Supplement payment under Part VIB of the *Veterans' Entitlements Act 1986*.
- Quarterly pension supplement under the *Social Security Act 1991* or the *Veterans' Entitlements Act 1986*.
- Remote area allowance.
- Rent assistance.
- Stillborn baby payment paid by Centrelink.
- Telephone allowance under the *Social Security Act 1991*.
- The ex-gratia payment from the Australian Government, known as the Disaster Recovery Allowance for special category visa (subclass 444) holders for a disaster
  - that occurred in Australia during 2014–15 and future years, and
  - for which a determination under section 1061L of the *Social Security Act 1991* has been made.
- Utilities allowance under the *Social Security Act 1991*.
- Veterans supplement under the *Veterans' Entitlements Act 1986*.

Exempt Australian Defence Force and United Nations payments

- Certain pay and allowances for Australian Defence Force personnel (your employer will advise you if an amount is exempt).
- Compensation payments under the *Safety, Rehabilitation and Compensation Act 1988* for impairment or incapacity resulting from service with a United Nations armed force in an operation area described in Schedule 2 of the *Veterans' Entitlement Act 1986*.
- Compensation payments under the *Military Rehabilitation and Compensation Act 2004*, except those that are income-related payments.
- F-111 deseal/reseal ex-gratia lump sum payments.
- Pay and allowances for part-time service in the Australian Naval, Army or Air Force Reserve.
- Payments in relation to a recommendation by the Defence Force Ombudsman for abuse by a member of Defence.
- Some allowances to Australian Defence Force personnel who serve in prescribed overseas areas (your employer will advise you if an allowance is exempt).

Other exempt payments

- Certain amounts of interest from the Commonwealth on unclaimed money and property.
- Certain annuities and lump sums for an injured person under a structured settlement.
- Certain distributions from a pooled development fund.
- Certain distributions from an early stage venture capital limited partnership.
- Certain payments relating to persecution during the Second World War.
- Certain profits or gains from disposal of shares in a pooled development fund.
- Japanese internment compensation payments made under the *Compensation (Japanese Internment) Act 2001* or the *Veterans' Entitlements Act 1986*.
- Your share of certain profits or gains arising from disposal of investments by a venture capital limited partnership (VCLP), an early stage venture capital limited partnership (ESVCLP) or an Australian venture capital fund of funds (AFOF).

Non-assessable non-exempt income

The most common types of non-assessable non-exempt income are:

- super lump sum death benefits payments to
  - a dependant
  - someone who isn't a dependant but received the benefit because of the death of a member of the Australian Defence Force or an Australian police force (including Australian Protective Services) who died in the line of duty
- tax-free super lump sum benefits a person with a terminal medical condition existing at the time they received the lump sum, or within 90 days of its receipt
- amounts on which family trust distribution tax has been paid (see question **A5** in *Individual supplementary tax return instructions 2026*)
- genuine redundancy payments and early retirement scheme payments shown as 'Lump sum D' amounts on your income statement or payment summary
- National Rental Affordability Scheme (NRAS) payments or non-cash benefits (whether directly or indirectly, such as through an NRAS consortium of which you're a member) by a state or territory government or a relevant body established under a state or territory law
- that part of the taxable component of a death benefit employment termination payment (ETP) below the 2025–26 cap of $260,000 paid to a dependant
- the taxed element of a death benefit super income stream from an account-based pension to a death benefit dependant where either
  - the deceased was 60 years old or older at the time of their death
  - the recipient was 60 years old or older when they received the benefit
- the taxed element of a super income stream or lump sum paid from an account-based pension received by a person 60 years old or older
- the tax-free component of a super benefit paid from an account-based pension
- the tax-free component of an ETP.

Tax-free income for temporary residents

If you're a temporary resident, your foreign income is non-assessable non-exempt income except for some income you earned from your employment overseas while you're a temporary resident, which may be taxable.

You're a temporary resident if:

- you hold a temporary visa granted under the *Migration Act 1958*
- you and your spouse (if you had one) aren't an Australian resident within the meaning of the *Social Security Act 1991*.

If on 6 April 2006, or at any time after, you're an Australian resident for tax purposes but not a temporary resident, you're not entitled to the temporary resident exemptions from that time, even if you later hold a temporary visa.

For more information, go to ato.gov.au/foreignincomeexemption

Other amounts that you don't pay tax on

You don't pay tax on:

- most child support and spouse maintenance payments
- allowances you received as a volunteer in the Australian government funded Australian Volunteers Program
- government super contributions.

There are other amounts that you generally don't pay tax on, such as lottery winnings and inheritances.

For more information, go to ato.gov.au/amountsnotincome

Important information

Who can complete your tax return?

You can get someone else to help prepare and lodge your tax return for you, such as:

- A **family member or friend**, but they can't charge you a fee.
- **Tax Help** – a network of community volunteers who provide a free service to help people with simple tax affairs prepare their tax returns. Tax Help volunteers can help you online, by phone or in person at a Tax Help centres across Australia. To make an appointment or find Tax Help services near you, phone **13 28 61** (select option **3**, then option **2**). For more information on Tax Help, go to ato.gov.au/taxhelp
- **Registered tax agent**, only agents can charge you a fee to prepare and lodge your tax return.

Regardless of who helps you prepare and lodge your return:

- you must sign your tax return
- you're legally responsible for the accuracy of the information.

Lodge your tax return by 31 October 2026

If you're lodging your own tax return, you need to lodge it by 31 October each year.

If you choose to use the services of a registered tax agent, they will generally have special lodgment schedules and can lodge tax returns for clients later than 31 October. If you're using a registered tax agent, you need to engage them before 31 October.

If you're having difficulties meeting your tax obligations or are unable to lodge by 31 October, contact us as soon as possible.

Failure to lodge on time penalty

We may apply a penalty for failure to lodge on time if you don't lodge your tax return by the due date.

Generally, we apply one penalty unit for every 28 days (or part thereof) that your tax return is overdue, to a maximum of 5 penalty units. For more information regarding penalty units, go to ato.gov.au/failuretolodgeontimepenalty

We recognise that sometimes people don't meet their lodgment obligations on time, even with the best intentions. Generally, we don't apply penalties in isolated cases of late lodgment. We consider your circumstances when deciding what action to take.

Where to send your tax return

Within Australia

To lodge **online** using myTax, go to ato.gov.au/lodgeonline

Most myTax lodgments process and refunds issue within 10 business days.

To lodge a **paper** tax return, either:

- mail it in the pre-addressed envelope that came with it
- mail it in your own envelope and address it to
  Australian Taxation Office
  GPO Box 9845
  (insert the name and postcode of your nearest capital city)
  For example:
  Australian Taxation Office
  GPO Box 9845
  SYDNEY NSW 2001

Most refunds for paper tax returns process within 50 business days.

From overseas

To lodge **online** using myTax, go to ato.gov.au/lodgeonline

Most myTax lodgments process and refunds issue within 10 business days.

To lodge a **paper** tax return, either:

- mail it in the pre-addressed envelope that came with it, but first
  - cross out the barcode above the address
  - cross out **IN YOUR CAPITAL CITY**
  - write **SYDNEY NSW 2001, AUSTRALIA**
- mail it in your own envelope and address it to
  Australian Taxation Office
  GPO Box 9845
  SYDNEY NSW 2001, AUSTRALIA

Most refunds for paper tax returns process within 50 business days.

When can you expect your notice of assessment?

Our standard processing time for processing your tax return is:

- 10 business days, if you lodge online
- 50 business days, if you lodge on paper.

Your notice of assessment will be:

- sent to your *myGov* inbox, if you have a *myGov* account, regardless of whether you lodge your tax return online or by paper
- sent to you by mail (post), if you don't have a *myGov* account.

To check the progress of your tax return:

- go to ato.gov.au/progressofreturn
- phone **13 28 61** and
  - choose option **1** then option **1**
  - ask one of our customer service representatives to do a search for you.

Our commitment to you

If you believe we haven't met your expectations or conducted ourselves as outlined in our Charter, we support your right to make a complaint.

We're committed to treating complaints seriously by dealing with them quickly, fairly and learning from them. Making a complaint won't affect your relationship with us.

If you disagree with a technical decision we've made about your tax affairs, you have the right to have the decision reviewed through the formal process. For more information, go to ato.gov.au/disputeorobjecttoATO

Before you lodge a complaint, check the options we have to assist you with your issue on ato.gov.au/complaints

If you still have concerns about an issue, you can:

- discuss it with an ATO officer who will aim to resolve your issue
- try to sort it out with the ATO officer you've been dealing with or phone the number you've been given
- talk to the ATO officer's manager if you're not satisfied
- consider making a formal complaint if you're still not satisfied.

How to make a complaint

To make a complaint:

- go to ato.gov.au/complaints
- phone our complaints line on **1800 199 010** between 8:00am and 6:00pm, Monday to Friday (local time), except national public holidays
- phone the National Relay Service on **13 36 77** if you find it hard to hear or speak to people who use a phone
- write to
  Australian Taxation Office
  PO Box 1271
  ALBURY NSW 2640

If you have previously lodged a complaint and you're not satisfied with the outcome, you can ask for your complaint to be escalated to a more senior officer for review. To escalate your complaint, contact ATO Complaints.

Other avenues to make a complaint

If you're not satisfied with your complaint outcome or the way the ATO handled the outcome of your complaint, you can request an independent investigation by the Tax Ombudsman. To contact the Tax Ombudsman:

- go to taxombudsman.gov.au
- phone **1300 448 829**
- write to
  TAX OMBUDSMAN
  GPO Box 551
  SYDNEY NSW 2001

More information

Website

For information on anything that you read in *Individual tax return instructions 2026*, go to ato.gov.au/taxreturninstructions2026

Our tools and calculators can help you complete your tax return, go to ato.gov.au/calculators

Publications

To get publications, tax rulings, practice statements and forms we refer to in *Individual tax return instructions 2026*, go to ato.gov.au/formsandinstructions

Phone

We need to establish your identity before discussing or updating your tax record. We'll ask you questions using the information we hold about you, including information from third parties and other government departments. We recommend you have your TFN ready when you phone us.

Voiceprint

Voice authentication is a fast and easy way to confirm your identity when you phone us. This is the digital representation of the sound, rhythm, physical characteristics and patterns of your voice. Once you save it with us, we confirm your identity by matching the characteristics of your voice to your voiceprint.

Our phone lines are open Monday to Friday 8.00am to 6.00pm except on Australian national public holidays. For more information on hours of service to the community, go to ato.gov.au/contactus

ATO individual self-help services – 13 28 65

Our automated phone service is available 24 hours a day, every day, so you can:

- check the progress of your tax return
- search for your lost super
- make a payment arrangement
- apply for a refund of franking credits
- request your existing TFN
- check the progress of your compassionate release of super application.

Individuals – 13 28 61

Phone between 8:00 am and 6:00 pm Monday to Friday, you can enquire about:

- lodging your tax return, including online using myTax
- pay as you go (PAYG), including instalment activity statements
- student and training support loans
- questions in *Individual tax return instructions 2026* or *Individual tax return instructions supplement 2026*
- capital gains, rental income and foreign income
- your notice of assessment
- your income tax account
- payment arrangements
- binding oral advice.

If you would like to speak in a language other than English, phone the Translating and Interpreting service on **13 14 50**.

From overseas

Phone **+61 2 6216 1111**

during our business hours, 8.00am to 5.00pm (Australian Eastern Daylight Time) Monday to Friday. Our phone number may not work from all countries.

If you would like to speak in a language other than English, phone the Translating and Interpreting service (TIS National) on **+61 3 9268 8332** and request to be connected to the ATO in the language you want to speak in.

Indigenous Helpline – 13 10 30

This service specialises in helping Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples with their personal tax matters.

People with difficulty hearing or speaking

If you have difficulty hearing or speaking to people who use a phone, you can contact us through the National Relay Service (NRS). For more information, go to accesshub.gov.au

For information about *Individual tax return instructions 2026* in accessible formats, see the back cover.

Business – 13 28 66
Complaints – 1800 199 010
EFT – 1800 802 308

For enquiries about direct deposit of your tax refund

Services Australia Families line – 13 61 50

Superannuation – 13 10 20

To report phoenix, tax evasion or shadow economy activity confidentially:

Phone (FREECALL) – **1800 060 062**

Go to ato.gov.au/tipoff

Mail – **Australian Taxation Office**
Tax Integrity Centre
PO Box 188
ALBURY NSW 2640
Mark all letters as 'in confidence'.

If you're from a non-English speaking background, for help phone the Translating and Interpreting Service (TIS) on **13 14 50**.

Arabic
إذا كنت لاتجيد التحدث باللغة الإنجليزية وكنت في حاجة إلى مساعدة من مكتب الضرائب، الرجاء الاتصال بخدمة الترجمة الخطية والشفهية (TIS) علي الرقم 13 14 50.

Assyrian
ܐܢ ܟܝ ܒܥܝ ܕܬܫܡܥ ܠܫܘܢܐ ܐܢܓܠܝܐ ܘܒܥܝ ܥܕܪܐ ܡܢ ATO، ܡܛܝ ܠܓܒ ܡܬܪܓܡ ܘܦܫܪ ܫܪܘܬ (TIS: Translating and Interpreting Service) ܒܛܠܦܘܢ ܥܠ 13 14 50.

Burmese
အကယ်၍သင်ဟာ အင်္ဂလိပ်ဘာသာစကား ကောင်းစွာမပြောနိုင်ဘူးဆိုရင်၊ ATO ထံကလည်း အကူအညီလိုအပ်ခဲ့ရင်၊ ဘာသာပြန်နဲ့ စကားပြန်ဝန်ဆောင်မှု (TIS: Translating and Interpreting Service) ကို ၁၃ ၁၄ ၅၀ မှာ ဖုန်းဆက်ပါ။

Chinese
如果你的英语说得不好而需要税务局的帮助，请拨打13 14 50 联系翻译及传译服务处。

Dari
اگر لسا ن انگلیسی را خوب گپ نمیزنید و به کمک اداره ما لیا ت احتیا ج دارید، به اداره خد ما ت ترجما ن کتبی و شفا هی به نمبر ۱۳۱۴۵۰ تیلفو ن کنید.

Dinka
Naa cï ye jam në thoŋ ë Dïŋëlïth apath ku gör koony tënë mäktäb de tɛkˈ ke yï yub Kïdïma de Tarjama ku Wërëthok (TIS) Tälapun: 13 14 50.

Hindi
यदि आप अंग्रेजी अच्छी तरह से नहीं बोल पाते और आपको ATO से मदद की ज़रूरत है, तो अनुवाद और व्याख्या सेवा (TIS: Translating and Interpreting Service) को 13 14 50 पर फ़ोन करें.

Indonesian
Jika bahasa Inggris Anda kurang baik, dan membutuhkan bantuan dari ATO (Kantor Pajak Australia), teleponlah Layanan Penerjemahan dan Juru Bahasa (TIS: Translating and Interpreting Service) di 13 14 50.

Japanese
英語でお困りの方で、国税庁のサポートが必要な場合は、翻訳通訳サービス(TIS) 13 14 50 にお電話ください。

Khmer
ប្រសិនបើលោកអ្នកមិនសូវចេះនិយាយភាសាអង់គ្លេសទេ បើយើញត្រូវការជំនួយពីការិយាល័យពន្ធដារ សូមទូរស័ព្ទទៅកិច្ចបំរើបកប្រែភាសា (TIS) តាមលេខ 13 14 50។

Korean
영어를 잘하지 못하지만 국세청으로부터 도움을 받고자 한다면, 번역 및 통역 서비스 (TIS) 13 14 50 번으로 전화하십시오.

Persian
اگر بخوبی انگلیسی صحبت نمیکنید و به کمک اداره ما لیا ت نیا ز دارید، به اداره خد ما ت ترجمه کتبی و شفا هی به شما ره ۱۳۱۴۵۰ تلفن فرما ئید.

Russian
Если Вы недостаточно хорошо говорите по-английски, и Вам требуется помощь Налоговой Службы, позвоните в Службу Переводов (TIS) по телефону 13 14 50.

Serbian
Ако не говорите добро енглески и треба вам помоћ од Пореске управе (Tax Office), назовите Службу преводилаца и тумача (TIS) на 13 14 50.

Somali
Haddii aadan si fiican ugu hadlin Ingiriiska aadna caawimo uga baahan tahay ATO, wac Adeega Tarjumida Qoraalka iyo Afcelinta (TIS: Translating and Interpreting Service) telefoon 13 14 50.

Thai
หากท่านพูดภาษาอังกฤษได้ไม่คล่อง และต้องการความช่วยเหลือจากกรมสรรพากร กรุณาติดต่อฝ่ายบริการล่ามและแปลภาษา (Translating and Interpreting Service - TIS) ที่หมายเลข 13 14 50.

Turkish
İyi İngilizce konuşamıyorsanız ve Vergi Dairesi'nden yardıma ihtiyacınız varsa, 13 14 50 numaralı telefondan Yazılı ve Sözlü çeviri Servisi'ni (TIS) arayın.

Vietnamese
Nếu quí vị không nói rành tiếng Anh và cần sự giúp đỡ của Văn Phòng Thuế Vụ, xin gọi cho Dịch Vụ Thông Ngôn và Phiên Dịch (TIS) ở số 13 14 50.

Tax Help

Tax Help is a network of community volunteers who provide a free and confidential service to help people with simple tax affairs prepare their tax returns online.

To find a Tax Help centre near you or to make an appointment, phone **13 28 61**.

For people with difficulty hearing or speaking

You can prepare and lodge your tax return online using myTax in ATO online services through myGov. For more information, go to ato.gov.au/lodgeonline

Lodge online when and where you want

myTax

Visit **ato.gov.au/lodgeonline**
You can also use a registered tax agent

Australian Government
Australian Taxation Office

Tax return for individuals
1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026

2026

Prepare this tax return using the *Individual tax return instructions 2026* available at **ato.gov.au/instructions26**

- Print clearly using a black pen only.
- Use BLOCK LETTERS and print one character in each box.

S M I T H S T

- Print X in all appropriate boxes.
- Don't use correction fluid or tape.
- Complete your details carefully to avoid delays in processing your tax return.

25410626

Individual information

Your tax file number (TFN) See the Privacy statement in the **Taxpayer's declaration**.

Are you an Australian resident? Yes ☐ No ☐

Your name (Print your full name)

Title: Mr ☐ Mrs ☐ Miss ☐ Ms ☐ Other

Family name

First given name

Other given names

Has any part of your name changed since completing your last tax return? No ☐ Read on. Yes ☐ See **Completing individual information in your tax return** in the instructions.

Your postal address Print the address where you want your mail sent.

Suburb/town/locality State/territory Postcode

Country if not Australia

Has this address changed since completing your last tax return? No ☐ Yes ☐

Is your home address different from your postal address? No ☐ Read on. Yes ☐ Print your home address below.

Suburb/town/locality State/territory Postcode

Country if not Australia

Your contact details

Your mobile phone number

Your daytime phone number (if different from your mobile phone number)

Your email address

We may use your contact details to:
- advise you of tax return lodgment options
- correspond with you with regards to your tax and superannuation affairs
- issue notices to you
- conduct research and marketing.

Will you need to lodge an Australian tax return in the future? Yes ☐ Don't know ☐ No ☐ FINAL TAX RETURN

Your date of birth
If you were under 18 years old on 30 June 2026, you must complete question **A1**.

Day ☐☐ / Month ☐☐ / Year ☐☐☐☐

Provide your date of birth to avoid delays in the processing of your tax return.

Electronic funds transfer (EFT)
We need your financial institution details to pay any refund owing to you, even if you have provided them to us before.
Write the BSB number, account number and account name.

BSB number (must be 6 digits) ☐☐☐☐☐☐ Account number ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐

Account name (for example, JQ Citizen. Don't show the account type, such as cheque, savings, mortgage offset)

Income

1 Salary or wages

Your main salary and wage occupation ☐☐☐☐☐☐

Attach here all documents that the instructions tell you to attach.
Don't send in your tax return until all requested attachments are attached.

Your TFN

25410726

Income – *continued*

8 Australian superannuation lump sum payments

Tax withheld – don't show cents

Date of payment Day / Month / Year

Payer's ABN

Taxable component

Taxed element — Income – don't show cents — TYPE — **Q**

Untaxed element — **P**

9 Attributed personal services income

Tax withheld – don't show cents — Income – don't show cents — **O**

TOTAL TAX WITHHELD Add up the $ boxes.

Don't include total income here

10 Gross interest

If you're a foreign resident, make sure you print your country of residence on page 1.

Gross interest — Income – don't show cents — **L**

TFN amounts withheld from gross interest — **M**

11 Dividends

If you're a foreign resident, make sure you print your country of residence on page 1.

Unfranked amount — **S**

Franked amount — **T**

TFN amounts withheld from dividends — **V**

Franking credit — **U**

12 Employee share schemes

Discount from taxed upfront schemes – eligible for reduction — **D**

Discount from taxed upfront schemes – not eligible for reduction — **E**

Discount from deferral schemes — **F**

Total assessable discount amount — **B**

TFN amounts withheld from discounts — **C**

Foreign source discounts — **A**

I If you completed the ***Tax return for individuals (supplementary section) 2026***, write here the amount from TOTAL SUPPLEMENT INCOME OR LOSS on page 15. — LOSS

TOTAL INCOME OR LOSS Add up the income amounts and deduct any loss amount in the $ boxes on pages 2 and 3. — LOSS

Deductions

You must read the deductions section in the instructions if you are claiming deductions for expenses that relate to your work as an employee at questions **D1**–**D6**.

D1 **Work-related car expenses** — **A** $,00 CLAIM TYPE

D2 **Work-related travel expenses** — **B** $,00

D3 **Work-related clothing, laundry and dry cleaning expenses** — **C** $,00 CLAIM TYPE

D4 **Work-related self-education expenses** — **D** $,00 CLAIM TYPE

D5 **Other work-related expenses** — **E** $,00

D6 **Low value pool deduction** — **K** $,00

D7 **Interest income deductions** — **I** $,00

D8 **Dividend deductions** — **H** $,00

D9 **Gifts or donations** — **J** $,00

D10 **Cost of managing tax affairs**

Litigation costs — **L** $,00

Other expenses incurred in managing your tax affairs — **M** $,00

D If you completed the ***Tax return for individuals (supplementary section) 2026***, write here the amount from TOTAL SUPPLEMENT DEDUCTIONS on page 15. ▶ $,00

TOTAL DEDUCTIONS Add amounts at questions **D1** to **D** ▶ $,00

SUBTOTAL TOTAL INCOME OR LOSS less TOTAL DEDUCTIONS $,00 LOSS

Losses

L1 **Tax losses of earlier income years**

Primary production losses carried forward from earlier income years — **Q** $,00

Primary production losses claimed this income year — **F** $,00

Non-primary production losses carried forward from earlier income years — **R** $,00

Non-primary production losses claimed this income year — **Z** $,00

TAXABLE INCOME OR LOSS

If you were not required to complete **L1**, write the amount from **SUBTOTAL** above here. $,00 LOSS

If you completed **L1**, add up the amounts you wrote at **F** and **Z** and take the total away from the amount you wrote at **SUBTOTAL**. Write the answer at **$ TAXABLE INCOME OR LOSS**.

Make sure that you complete question M2.

Your TFN

25410826

Tax offsets

T1 Seniors and pensioners (includes self-funded retirees)

If you had a spouse during 2025–26, you must also complete **Spouse details – married or de facto**.

The ATO will work out this tax offset amount. Print your code letter in the **TAX OFFSET CODE** box.

N TAX OFFSET CODE

Y VETERAN CODE

T2 Australian superannuation income stream

S $,

T If you completed the ***Tax return for individuals (supplementary section) 2026***, write here the amount from TOTAL SUPPLEMENT TAX OFFSETS on page 16.

$,

TOTAL TAX OFFSETS Add up all the tax offset amounts at questions **T2** and **T**.

U $,

Medicare levy related questions

M1 Medicare levy reduction or exemption

NOTE
Only certain taxpayers are entitled to a Medicare levy reduction or exemption. Read **M1 Medicare levy reduction or exemption** in the instructions to work out if you are eligible to claim.

Reduction based on family income
Number of dependent children and students **Y** ☐☐

Exemption categories
Full 2.0% levy exemption – number of days **V** ☐☐☐ CLAIM ☐ TYPE
Half 2.0% levy exemption – number of days **W** ☐☐☐

If you have completed question **M1** and had a spouse during 2025–26, you must also complete **Spouse details – married or de facto**.

M2 Medicare levy surcharge (MLS)

THIS QUESTION IS COMPULSORY FOR ALL TAXPAYERS.

If you don't complete this question, you may be charged the full Medicare levy surcharge.
To help you determine if you have to pay the surcharge read **M2 Medicare levy surcharge** in the instructions.

For the **whole** period 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026 were **you** and **all** of your dependants (including your spouse) – if you had any – covered by private patient **hospital** cover?

E **Yes** ☐ You **must** complete **Private health insurance policy details** on the next page. You have now finished this question.

No ☐ Read on.

For the whole of 2025–26 were you:

- **a single person** – without a dependent child or children – and your income for surcharge purposes (including your total reportable fringe benefits amounts) was $101,000 or less or
- **a member of a family** – which may consist of you and your spouse (married or de facto) with or without a dependent child or children; or a sole parent with a dependent child or children – and the combined income for surcharge purposes (including the total reportable fringe benefits amounts) of you and your spouse (if you had one) was $202,000 or less (plus $1,500 for each dependent child after the first)
- and all of your dependants (if you had any) in a Medicare levy exemption category?

No ☐ You may have to pay the surcharge. Read **M2 Medicare levy surcharge** in the instructions.

Yes ☐ You don't have to pay the surcharge. You must write **365** at **A**.

You must write the following at **A**:

- **0** when you have to pay the surcharge for the whole period 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026
- **365** when you **don't** have to pay the surcharge for the whole period 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026
- **the number of days** you **don't** have to pay the surcharge for part of the period 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026.

→ Number of days you **don't** have to pay the surcharge **A** ☐☐☐

If you had a spouse during 2025–26, complete **Spouse details – married or de facto**.
If you were covered by private patient hospital cover at any time during 2025–26, you **must** complete **Private health insurance policy details**.

Private health insurance policy details

You must read **Private health insurance policy details** in the instructions before completing this question.
Complete all the labels below unless directed in the instructions.

Health insurer ID **B** ☐☐☐ Membership number **C** ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Your premiums eligible for Australian Government rebate **J** $ ☐☐,☐☐☐.☒ Your Australian Government rebate received **K** $ ☐☐,☐☐☐.☒

Benefit code **L** ☐☐ Tax claim code CODE ☐

Health insurer ID **B** ☐☐☐ Membership number **C** ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Your premiums eligible for Australian Government rebate **J** $ ☐☐,☐☐☐.☒ Your Australian Government rebate received **K** $ ☐☐,☐☐☐.☒

Benefit code **L** ☐☐ Tax claim code CODE ☐

Health insurer ID **B** ☐☐☐ Membership number **C** ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Your premiums eligible for Australian Government rebate **J** $ ☐☐,☐☐☐.☒ Your Australian Government rebate received **K** $ ☐☐,☐☐☐.☒

Benefit code **L** ☐☐ Tax claim code CODE ☐

Health insurer ID **B** ☐☐☐ Membership number **C** ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Your premiums eligible for Australian Government rebate **J** $ ☐☐,☐☐☐.☒ Your Australian Government rebate received **K** $ ☐☐,☐☐☐.☒

Benefit code **L** ☐☐ Tax claim code CODE ☐

Adjustments

A1 Under 18

If you were under 18 years old on 30 June 2026, you must complete this question or you may be taxed at a higher rate. For more information, read the instructions for question **A1**.

J $ ☐☐☐,☐☐☐.☒ TYPE ☐

A2 Part-year tax-free threshold

Date Day ☐☐ / Month ☐☐ / Year ☐☐☐☐

Months eligible for threshold **N** ☐☐

Before completing this question, read the instructions for question **A2**.

A3 Government super contributions

Before completing this question, read the instructions for question **A3**.

Income from investment, partnership and other sources **F** $ ☐☐,☐☐☐,☐☐☐.☒ CODE ☐

Other income from employment and business **G** $ ☐☐,☐☐☐,☐☐☐.☒ LOSS ☐

Other deductions from business income **H** $ ☐☐,☐☐☐,☐☐☐.☒

A4 Working holiday maker net income

D $ ☐☐,☐☐☐,☐☐☐.☒

Home country **E** ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Income tests

You must complete this section. If you had a spouse during 2025–26, you must also complete **Spouse details – married or de facto**.

If the amount is zero, write 0.

IT1 Total reportable fringe benefits amounts

Employers exempt from FBT under section 57A of the FBTAA 1986 **N** $, .

Employers not exempt from FBT under section 57A of the FBTAA 1986 **W** $, .

IT2 Reportable employer superannuation contributions **T** $, .

IT3 Tax-free government pensions **U** $, .

IT4 Target foreign income **V** $, .

IT5 Net financial investment loss **X** $, .

IT6 Net rental property loss **Y** $, .

IT7 Child support you paid **Z** $, .

IT8 Number of dependent children **D**

Spouse details – married or de facto

If you had a spouse during 2025–26, you must complete **Spouse details – married or de facto**.
We need the information you include in this section to assess your tax accurately.

If you didn't have a spouse, go to page 10.

Your spouse's name

If you had more than one spouse during 2025–26, print the name of your spouse on **30 June 2026** or your last spouse.

Family name

First given name

Other given names

Your spouse's date of birth **K** Day / Month / Year

Your spouse's gender Male Female Indeterminate

Period you had a spouse – married or de facto

Did you have a spouse for the full year – 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026? **L** Yes No

If you didn't have a spouse for the full year, write the dates you had a spouse between 1 July 2025 and 30 June 2026.

From **M** Day / Month / Year

To **N** Day / Month / Year

Did your spouse die during the year? Yes No

Spouse details – married or de facto – *continued*

The information on this page relates to your spouse's income.
You must complete all labels.

If the amount is zero, write 0.

Your spouse's 2025–26 taxable income (excluding any assessable first home super saver released amount)	**O**	$,, .00
Your spouse's share of trust income on which the trustee is assessed under section 98, and which has not been included in your spouse's taxable income	**T**	$, .00
Distributions to your spouse on which family trust distribution tax has been paid and which your spouse would have had to show as assessable income if the tax had not been paid	**U**	$, .00
Your spouse's total reportable fringe benefits amounts		
Employers exempt from FBT under section 57A of the FBTAA 1986	**R**	$, .00
Employers not exempt from FBT under section 57A of the FBTAA 1986	**S**	$, .00
Amount of Australian Government pensions and allowances (see **Q6 Australian Government pensions and allowances** in the instructions) that your spouse received in 2025–26 (exclude **exempt pension** income)	**P**	$, .00
Amount of exempt pension income (see **Spouse details – married or de facto** in the instructions) that your spouse received in 2025–26. Don't include any amount paid under the *Military Rehabilitation and Compensation Act 2004*	**Q**	$, .00
Amount of your spouse's reportable superannuation contributions (which is the total of reportable employer superannuation contributions and deductible personal superannuation contributions)	**A**	$, .00
Other specified exempt payments (see **Spouse details – married or de facto** in the instructions) that your spouse received	**B**	$, .00
Your spouse's target foreign income	**C**	$, .00
Your spouse's total net investment loss (total of net financial investment loss and net rental property loss)	**D**	$, .00
Child support your spouse paid	**E**	$, .00

Family Assistance consent – Complete this section only if you consent to use part or all of your 2026 tax refund to repay your spouse's Family Assistance debt.

Complete the details below only if:

- you were the spouse of a family tax benefit (FTB) claimant, or the spouse of a child care assistance claimant on 30 June 2026 **and**
- your spouse has given you authority to quote their customer reference number (CRN) in your tax return – if your spouse does not know their CRN, they can contact Services Australia **and**
- your spouse has a Family Assistance debt or expects to have a Family Assistance debt for 2026 **and**
- you expect to receive a refund for 2026 **and**
- you consent to use part or all of your refund to repay your spouse's Family Assistance debt.

Do you consent to use part or all of your 2026 tax refund to repay your spouse's Family Assistance debt?

No ☐ You don't need to complete this section. Go to page 10.

Yes ☐ Your spouse's CRN **Z** ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

I consent to the ATO using part or all of my 2026 tax refund to repay any Family Assistance debt of my spouse, whose details I have provided above. I have obtained my spouse's permission to quote their CRN.

Your signature for Services Australia consent purposes only

Date

Day ☐☐ / Month ☐☐ / Year ☐☐☐☐

If you are completing the supplementary section (pages 13–16) of your tax return, attach it here.

Taxpayer's declaration

All taxpayers must sign and date the declaration below.

Read and answer the questions below before you sign the Taxpayer's declaration.

1 Are you required to complete any of the questions in the *Tax return for individuals (supplementary section) 2026*?
To find out, go to **ato.gov.au/suppquestions2026**

No ☐ Read on. **Yes** ☐ Attach the **supplementary section** to this page and read on.

2 Have the instructions asked you to attach further information relating to specific questions?

No ☐ Read on. **Yes** ☐ Attach the information to page 3 in your tax return and read on.

Make sure you have also attached all other documents that the instructions tell you to.

Privacy

The ATO is authorised by the *Taxation Administration Act 1953* to request your tax file number (TFN). We will use your TFN to identify you in our records. It is not an offence not to provide your TFN. However if you don't provide your TFN, your assessment may be delayed.

Taxation law authorises the ATO to collect information and to disclose it to other government agencies. For information about your privacy go to **ato.gov.au/privacy**

I declare that:

- all the information I have given on this tax return, including any attachments, is true and correct
- I have shown all my income – including net capital gains – for tax purposes for 2025–26
- I have completed and attached the supplementary section, schedules and other attachments – as appropriate – that the instructions told me to provide
- I have completed question **M2 – Medicare levy surcharge**
- I have the necessary receipts and/or other records – or expect to obtain the necessary written evidence within a reasonable time of lodging this tax return – to support my claims for deductions and tax offsets.

IMPORTANT

The tax law imposes heavy penalties for giving false or misleading information.

FOR YOUR TAX RETURN TO BE VALID YOU MUST SIGN BELOW.

Date

Day ☐☐ / Month ☐☐ / Year ☐☐☐☐

The ATO will issue your assessment based on your tax return. However, the ATO has some time to review your tax return, and issue an amended assessment if a review shows inaccuracies that change the assessment. The standard review period is 2 years, but for some taxpayers it is 4 years. For more information, go to **ato.gov.au/notices**